Spectral-Geometric Exchange Constants: Projecting Discrete Spectra onto Continuous Manifolds*

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(Dated: April 16, 2026)

Compact Lie groups have discrete unitary representations (Peter–Weyl theorem); the GeoVac label set exploits this discreteness directly. Transcendental conversion factors appear when these discrete representations are projected onto non-compact coordinate systems used for measurement. We classify these factors by the type of compactness mismatch they mediate—six exchange-constant tiers (intrinsic, conformal/calibration, embedding, algebraic-implicit, composition, inner-factor input data) plus the algebraic (no-exchange) case, seven categories in all, spanning the GeoVac hierarchy through Level 5 plus the almost-commutative inner factor—and identify them with Weyl–Selberg exchange constants of spectral geometry. The falsifiable claim: the transcendental content of any GeoVac observable is determined entirely by the type of projection linking the compact discrete description to the non-compact coordinate system (this strong, observable-indexed form is under strain from the H_2 dissociation energy and is not reconciled with the body's weaker, route-indexed Claim 4; see Sec. VI).

Beyond the basis-level catalog, three theorems classify the spectral content of operators on round S^3: **(Theorem 1)** for the Camporesi–Higuchi D against D^2, operator order is the primary discriminant of transcendental class (not for every second-order operator: $\nabla^*\nabla$ fails)—the squared Dirac operator D^2 produces π^{even} exclusively at every integer s, while the first-order Dirac operator D produces odd-zeta content $\zeta_R(2k+1)$ at odd s (conjecturally outside $\mathbb{Q}(\pi)$; Apéry proved only that $\zeta_R(3)$ is irrational); **(Theorem 2)** the full classification is three-axis, adding bundle type (scalar vs. spinor, modulating coefficients only) and diagram topology (free vs. vertex-restricted, introducing Dirichlet L-values $G = \beta(2)$, $\beta(4)$ through the quarter-integer Hurwitz shift); **(Theorem 3)** the three components of the fine-structure-constant combination $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$ of Paper 2 [8] have spectral homes of distinct type (finite Casimir trace, infinite Dirichlet series at the packing exponent, Dirac mode degeneracy on the spinor bundle); B and F share the (second-order, scalar) cell of the three-axis grid and differ by finite versus infinite summation, and Δ sits in the (first-order, spinor) cell. The combination rule—K matches α^{-1} to 4.8×10^{-7} relative, and α approximately satisfies the cubic $\alpha^3 - K\alpha + 1 = 0$ to 8.8×10^{-8}—remains a numerical Observation without first-principles derivation.

A complementary **Observation (structural incommensurability)** catalogues the meta-pattern: GeoVac observables that look unitary at the surface (K itself; two-loop QED on S^3; zero structure of the GeoVac zeta) resolve under structural analysis into objects of different type (not always different cells of the three-axis grid: K's B and F share one). No further unification is currently visible. The taxonomy is read (a census and a reading, not a classification) in terms of Mellin transforms of heat kernels: the free heat kernel produces π^{even} in its integer-s spectral-zeta values (for Δ_{LB} and D^2), the interaction-deformed kernel produces L-content via vertex parity, and operator order determines whether the Mellin integrand samples squared or raw eigenvalues. The taxonomy is R-independent, persisting in the flat-space limit via Weyl's law.

I. INTRODUCTION

The Geometric Vacuum program constructs discrete lattice Hamiltonians by identifying the natural geometry of each quantum system and working in the label set and channel structure of the coordinates in which separation occurs, which yields sparse Hamiltonian matrices [1–3]. A persistent observation across the hierarchy of natural geometries is that the discrete algebraic structures—integer quantum-number labels (with the diagonal $SO(4)$ Casimir $n^2 - 1$ on them), finite recurrence relations, Gaunt integrals built from Wigner $3j$ symbols—are entirely self-contained, but that their connection to physical observables in continuous coordinate systems always introduces transcendental constants.

The thesis of this paper is that these transcendental conversion factors are consequences of *compactness*. Compact Lie groups have discrete unitary representations (the Peter–Weyl theorem [33]); the GeoVac label set exploits this discreteness directly. Transcendental numbers enter when—and only when—those discrete representations are translated into non-compact coordinate systems used for measurement. The taxonomy developed below classifies the resulting conversion factors by the type of compact-to-non-compact projection that produces them. This yields a falsifiable structural claim: the transcendental content of any GeoVac observable is determined entirely by the type of projection linking the compact discrete description to the non-compact coordinate system (Claim 4, Sec. VI; the body states a weaker,

* Paper 18 in the Geometric Vacuum series

route-indexed form, and the two are not reconciled).

The simplest instance is already visible in Paper 0's packing construction [1]. Axiom 2 (geometric indifference) forces states onto isotropic shells—circles, i.e. copies of S^1. The shell is compact; its circumference $2\pi r$ introduces π into the area formula $\sigma_0 = \pi d_0^2/2$ and hence into the state count $N_k = A_k/\sigma_0 = 2(2k-1)$. The integer state count is a consequence of compact topology; π is the price of expressing that count as a ratio of continuous areas. This pattern—compact geometry producing integer quantum numbers, with π entering through projection onto non-compact coordinates—recurs at every level of the hierarchy.

The conversion factors are instances of Weyl's law [28] and the Selberg trace formula [29]; what is new is their systematic identification across the GeoVac hierarchy, culminating in a falsifiable observable classification (Claim 4) and the observation that operator order on the compact space determines the motivic weight of the resulting transcendental content.

II. CATALOG OF EXCHANGE CONSTANTS

A. Level 1: the energy shell p_0 and the matched $\kappa = -1/16$ ($S^3 \to \mathbb{R}^3$)

The compactness of S^3 is what makes the Laplace–Beltrami eigenvalues discrete integers (on the graph's label set (n, l, m), $-\Delta_{S^3}$ acts as the diagonal $SO(4)$ Casimir $n^2 - 1$). The passage to the non-compact $\mathbb{R}^3$ energy scale is Fock's energy shell $p_0^2 = -2E$; κ plays a narrower role, matching the graph's extremal eigenvalue (a band edge) to $-\frac{1}{2}$ by construction (its coincidence with the geometric $1/16$ of the Fock projection is an Observation).

The continuum S^3 Laplace–Beltrami operator — which the graph's edge Laplacian does *not* converge to (it preserves l and splits into $n_{\max}$ disconnected blocks, Paper 0 §VI; corrected 2026-09-25 from "converges to") — has pure integer eigenvalues

$$\lambda_n = -(n^2 - 1), \qquad n = 1, 2, 3, \ldots \tag{1}$$

with degeneracy $g_n = n^2$ [3]. The physical hydrogen energy levels $E_n = -1/(2n^2)$ are related by the energy-shell constraint $p_0^2 = -2E$, which acts as a stereographic focal length projecting S^3 onto flat $\mathbb{R}^3$. The matched energy scale (an Observation, Papers 0/7)

$$\kappa = -\frac{1}{16} \tag{2}$$

calibrates the ground state energy: $\kappa \cdot \lambda_{\max} = E_H = -1/2$ Ha, where $\lambda_{\max} \to 8$ is the large-$n_{\max}$ maximum graph Laplacian eigenvalue [1] (twice the maximum degree, the band edge of two-dimensional grids; not an S^3 quantity). Per-shell energies $E_n = -Z^2/(2n^2)$ follow from $n^2 - 1$ on the labels through Fock's energy shell $p_0^2 = -2E$ (with $p_0 = Z/n$), not from κ and not from the graph Laplacian: **[MEASURED]** the spectrum of $\kappa\mathcal{L}$ is a band structure confined to $[-\frac{1}{2}, 0]$ (at $n_{\max} = 20$ its lowest levels are -0.4936, -0.4936, -0.4932, …, not a Rydberg ladder), and no variant of the graph Hamiltonian with nonzero edge coupling built on these labels has been shown to yield $-1/(2n^2)$ (Paper 7; the diagonal default, a node weight only, gives $-1/(2n^2)$ by construction).

The geometric quantity that κ's value *coincides* with is the fourth power of the inverse Fock conformal factor at the projection centre. If Ω is the conformal factor $\Omega = 2p_0/(p^2 + p_0^2)$ (so that $\Omega(0) = 2$ at the ground-state shell $p_0 = 1$, matching §VII F and Paper 7 [3]), then the Laplace–Beltrami operator on S^3 and the flat-space kinetic operator are related by $\nabla^2_{S^3} = \Omega^{-2}[\nabla^2_{\text{flat}} + \text{lower order}]$, and $1/\Omega^4(0) = 1/16$ [3]. That the matched κ coincides with this geometric $1/16$ is an Observation, not a derivation: no bridge derives the matching role from the geometry, and κ does not carry the conformal rescaling or the energy-shell normalization (§VII F).

What κ does is narrow. The graph Laplacian eigenvalue problem $L\psi = \lambda\psi$ is posed entirely in integers (integer matrix entries, algebraic eigenvalues), and κ only *matches* its extremal eigenvalue, a grid band edge, to $-\frac{1}{2}$ Ha by construction. The energies themselves do not pass through κ or the graph: they enter through the energy shell $p_0^2 = -2E$ acting on the Casimir $n^2 - 1$ of the labels, and it is that projection, not κ, that translates the dimensionless label data into atomic units.

B. Level 2: $e^a E_1(a)$ (Laguerre basis → prolate spheroid)

The Laguerre spectral basis inherits the compact angular structure of S^3; the Stieltjes seed $e^a E_1(a)$ enters when this basis is embedded in the non-compact prolate spheroidal coordinate, whose curvature introduces a pole absent from the compact description.

The prolate spheroidal radial solver uses a Laguerre spectral basis $\varphi_n(\xi) = e^{-\alpha(\xi-1)} L_n(2\alpha(\xi - 1))$ with matrix elements computed from three-term recurrences [4]. For σ states ($m = 0$), all matrix elements are purely algebraic: the Laguerre moment matrices $M_k[i, j] = \int_0^\infty x^k L_i(x) L_j(x) e^{-x} dx$ are band-structured matrices with rational entries, built from the recurrence $xL_n = -(n+1)L_{n+1} + (2n+1)L_n - nL_{n-1}$.

For $m \neq 0$ states, the centrifugal term $m^2/(\xi^2 - 1)$ introduces a $1/x$ singularity in the Laguerre variable $x = 2\alpha(\xi - 1)$. The associated Laguerre basis $L_n^{|m|}(x)$ with weight $x^{|m|} e^{-x}$ absorbs this singularity by construction. The centrifugal matrix elements decompose via partial-fraction expansion:

$$\frac{m^2}{\xi^2 - 1} = 4\alpha^2 m^2 \left[\frac{1}{x} - \frac{1}{x + 4\beta}\right], \tag{3}$$

where $\beta = \alpha(\xi_0 - 1)$ is the Laguerre scale offset. The two terms have fundamentally different algebraic character:

- The $1/x$ term produces a lowered moment $M_{-1}[i,j] = \int_0^\infty x^{|m|-1} L_i^{|m|}(x) L_j^{|m|}(x)\, e^{-x}\, dx$, which is fully algebraic via the DLMF 18.9.13 summation identity [27].

- The $1/(x+4\beta)$ term produces a Stieltjes matrix $J[i,j] = \int_0^\infty \frac{x^{|m|}}{x+a} L_i^{|m|}(x) L_j^{|m|}(x)\, e^{-x}\, dx$, where $a = 4\beta$. This matrix satisfies a three-term recurrence in the row/column indices, seeded by the single transcendental

$$S_0^{(\alpha)}(a) = \Gamma(\alpha+1)\, e^a\, E_{\alpha+1}(a), \tag{4}$$

where $E_n(a) = \int_1^\infty t^{-n} e^{-at}\, dt$ is the generalized exponential integral and $a = 4\beta$ is the Laguerre scale parameter [22]. For integer $\alpha = |m|$, all higher E_n reduce to $E_1(a)$ via a finite rational recurrence, so the entire matrix is built from algebraic operations plus one transcendental constant.

The computational cost of the transcendental seed is negligible: one call to $E_1(a)$, which achieves machine precision for $a \geq 4$ (covering all physical parameters). The seed then propagates through an $O(N^2)$ algebraic recurrence that produces all matrix elements. The continuous mathematics has been compressed from a *function* (the quadrature integrand over $[0,\infty)$) to a *constant* (the Stieltjes seed), with the entire function-level information reconstructed algebraically from that constant.

An unexpected computational bonus: the associated Laguerre basis converges *faster* than the ordinary Laguerre basis for $m \neq 0$ states. For $|m| = 1$ (π states), the associated basis is stable by $N = 10$, compared to non-monotonic convergence at $N \approx 20$ for the ordinary basis. For $|m| = 2$ (δ states), algebraic-quadrature agreement reaches $\sim 5 \times 10^{-9}$ (machine precision), with PES shape (equilibrium geometry) preserved exactly [22]. This suggests that identifying the exchange constant and absorbing it into the basis does not merely explain the transcendence—it *improves the spectral method*, because the adapted basis eliminates the curvature mismatch that the exchange constant mediates.

The Stieltjes seed $e^a E_1(a)$ is the Laplace transform of the rational function $1/(1+t)$ evaluated at a. It encodes how the Laguerre inner product (defined on the flat half-line $[0,\infty)$ with exponential weight) "sees" a shifted pole at $x = -a$ arising from the curvature of the prolate spheroidal coordinate system. On the label set, there is no pole; the centrifugal barrier is a selection rule encoded in the quantum numbers. The transcendental appears only when this selection rule is represented as a rational function in a continuous coordinate.

1. *The full Level-2 seed set:* $\{e^a E_1(a), \ln, \gamma_E\}$

Track J isolated $e^a E_1(a)$ for the *one*-electron problem at $m \neq 0$. The two-electron two-centre problem — the electron repulsion integrals over prolate spheroidal coordinates — is the same projection carried further, and it is worth recording what the complete seed set turns out to be, because the answer is smaller than one might fear and its two negatives are load-bearing.

A native closed-form evaluation of all four two-centre ERI classes (Paper 58) gives seeds

Class	Seeds	Weight
$(AA\|BB)$	— (elementary)	0
$(AA\|AB)$, $(AB\|BB)$	$e^a E_1(a)$, ln	1
$(AB\|AB)$	$e^a E_1(a)$, ln, γ_E	1

The seed set *grows* with class difficulty; the transcendence *weight* does not. Each new object has a structural home rather than being an independent import. The logarithm is the Neumann kernel $Q_0(\xi) = \frac{1}{2}\ln[(\xi+1)/(\xi-1)]$, i.e. the same prolate spheroidal curvature seen from the kernel side instead of the moment side; γ_E is not independent of E_1 at all, arriving with it through $E_1(z) = -\gamma_E - \ln z + \mathrm{Ein}(z)$. All three therefore sit in the *embedding* tier alongside $1/r_{12}$: they are the cost of the continuum two-centre geometry, not content of the discrete label/basis description.

Two absences matter more than the list. First, **no π survives**: it enters through the spherical normalisations and cancels identically against the 4π of the Coulomb kernel, so no calibration-tier constant appears anywhere in a two-centre ERI, and the master Mellin engine's $M_1/M_2/M_3$ sub-mechanisms are simply not in this chain. Second, **no weight-two object appears** — no dilogarithm, no $\zeta(2)$ — although the ordered $\xi_</\xi_>$ integral is formally an iterated integral over a simplex, exactly the shape that generically produces Li_2. It closes at weight one instead.

The two absences together are what make the $(AA|BB)$ class *decidable*. With no π and no weight-two content the closed form is $A_0(R) + \sum_j A_j(R) e^{-\lambda_j R}$ with A_j, λ_j rational, so by Lindemann–Weierstrass the entry vanishes if and only if every A_j does — a decision, not a numerical threshold. This is the sense in which cataloguing a transcendental *buys* something rather than merely labelling it: knowing the exact seed set is what licenses an exact zero test downstream.

2. *Three centres: the embedding tier is genus-graded*

The two-centre weight-one closure is a *genus-zero* fact, and it stops at two centres. The two-body three-centre integral $(XY|XZ)$—the first object a polyatomic requires, and one no prolate spheroidal system can hold, that coordinate having exactly two foci—is naturally evaluated in momentum space, where the Coulomb kernel is $4\pi/k^2$ and each centre enters as a phase $e^{i\mathbf{k}\cdot\mathbf{R}}$ rather

than a focus. There the two densities Fock-project onto spheres of *different* radii $\sqrt{c_1} \neq \sqrt{c_2}$ (c_i the Feynman parameters of the two densities), and the product of the two stereographic weights is the quartic

$$y^2 = (c_1 k^2 + 1)(c_2 k^2 + 1), \tag{5}$$

an elliptic curve. Its $D = 0$ period is a complete elliptic integral K, and the full integral is an integral of periods over this family (its radial core is not an elliptic dilogarithm, Paper 59), degenerating to the genus-zero two-centre curve only on the measure-zero locus $c_1 = c_2$ of a shared sphere.

The embedding tier therefore carries a *genus grading* at the level of the radial core: genus zero ($\{e^a E_1(a), \ln, \gamma_E\}$) at two centres, genus one (elliptic) at three. The two-centre exchange class builds the same fibre family and still closes at genus zero, so the integrated value was tested on its own: as a function of the bond angle it leaves the two-centre class too (Paper 59). The two two-centre negatives above—no π, no dilogarithm—are genus-zero properties and do *not* survive in the radial core at the third centre, which does not climb to a higher rung of the polylogarithm/MZV weight tower but leaves that tower entirely, orthogonally to the calibration $M_1/M_2/M_3$ Mellin sub-mechanisms. This is the transcendence-level statement of "no coordinate system for three foci," and the reason Gaussian orbitals—whose product theorem collapses three centres to one—displaced Slater orbitals for polyatomic quantum chemistry. The elliptic identification is numerical (the $D = 0$ period verified to 31 digits against a momentum-space evaluation that reproduces the exact three-centre integral to $\sim 10^{-14}$); no closed form is derived here. The rungs of more linked densities—trees of n densities and the banana ladder—are Paper 63 [19].

C. Level 3: $\mu(R)$ ($S^3 \times S^3 \to$ hyperspherical)

On the compact product space $S^3 \times S^3$, the two-electron Hamiltonian has purely algebraic matrix elements; the adiabatic eigenvalue $\mu(R)$ enters only when this compact description is reparameterized into the non-compact hyperspherical coordinate R.

The two-electron problem on $S^3 \times S^3$ is fully algebraic: the Hamiltonian matrix has entries given by Gaunt integrals (finite sums of Wigner $3j$ symbols with rational coefficients), and the eigenvalues are roots of a polynomial with algebraic coefficients. The Full CI solver exploits this, reaching 1.88% above exact for helium at $n_{\max} = 7$ (fixed $k = Z$ basis, physical Hamiltonian) with no transcendentals anywhere [7]. (An earlier sub-percent figure quoted here belonged to a model with a non-physical one-body graph hop, withdrawn 2026-09-25.)

The hyperspherical reparameterization introduces coordinates (R, α) where $R = \sqrt{r_1^2 + r_2^2}$ is the hyperradius and $\alpha = \arctan(r_2/r_1)$ is the hyperangle. The angular eigenvalues $\mu(R)$ depend parametrically on R because the effective angular Hamiltonian is $H(R) = H_0 + R \cdot V^{\text{coupling}}$ [6].

Each perturbation coefficient a_k in the expansion $\mu(R) = \mu^{(0)} + a_1 R + a_2 R^2 + \cdots$ has a closed form: the a_k are finite sums of algebraic numbers (square roots of rationals from Clebsch–Gordan coefficients) times powers of π^{-1} (from normalization over the angular domain $[0, \pi/2]$), arising from partial harmonic sums over SO(6) Casimir eigenstates [6]. For example, $a_1(n{=}1, Z) = (8/3\pi)(\sqrt{2} - 4Z)$. However, the full function $\mu(R)$ is not transcendental in the sense originally claimed. The angular Hamiltonian $H(R) = H_0 + R \cdot V_C$ is a linear matrix pencil, so its eigenvalues satisfy the characteristic polynomial

$$P(R, \mu) \;=\; \det\big(H_0 + R\,V_C - \mu\, I\big) = 0, \tag{6}$$

which is a polynomial of degree d in both R and μ (where d is the matrix dimension at a given truncation). The coefficients of P lie in $\mathbb{Q}(\pi, \sqrt{2})$, since H_0 has integer entries (SO(6) Casimir eigenvalues) and V_C has entries involving π^{-1} and $\sqrt{2}/\pi$ from the angular integrals. This makes $\mu(R)$ an *algebraic* function of R over the coefficient ring $\mathbb{Q}(\pi, \sqrt{2})$—it is a root of a polynomial, not a transcendental function [24].

The transcendental content of $\mu(R)$ is therefore *inherited* from the coupling matrix V_C, which contains upstream exchange constants of embedding type (π^{-1} from angular normalization, $\sqrt{2}$ from Gaunt-type integrals). The R-dependence itself introduces no new transcendentals: it is purely algebraic.

The failure of the Taylor/Padé expansion at large R (Track G [23]) is reinterpreted as a *branch point* phenomenon, not evidence of transcendence. The algebraic curve $P(R, \mu) = 0$ has branch points where eigenvalue sheets meet—these are the zeros of the discriminant $\Delta(R) = \text{disc}_\mu(P)$. The Taylor series around $R = 0$ has a convergence radius set by the nearest branch point in the complex R-plane. Padé approximants, being rational functions, also cannot cross branch points where $\mu(R)$ has square-root type singularities. But the implicit relation $P(R, \mu) = 0$ is exact for *all* R, including $R > 5$ where the series diverges. This has been verified computationally to machine precision at $R = 50$ bohr [24].

The $O(R) \to O(R^2)$ crossover, which was previously interpreted as a regime change requiring transcendental interpolation, is simply the behavior of an algebraic function whose dominant term changes character: at small R, the linear term $V_C \cdot R$ dominates; at large R, higher-order terms in the characteristic polynomial dominate. The crossover is smooth along the algebraic curve, even though it is singular from the perspective of a Taylor expansion centered at $R = 0$.

The crucial point remains that $\mu(R)$ is not intrinsic to the two-electron problem. It is an artifact of the hyperspherical coordinate system. The $S^3 \times S^3$ product space does not require $\mu(R)$; it only appears when one reparameterizes for computational efficiency. The exchange

rate between the discrete product-space description and the continuous hyperspherical description is an algebraic function of R, with transcendental content inherited from the angular coupling integrals.

D. Level 4: $\mu(\rho, R)$ (product space → molecule-frame hyperspherical)

At Level 4 the compact product basis (prolate spheroidal CI) is fully algebraic in its σ sector, and the non-compact mol-frame hyperspherical reparameterization introduces the piecewise-algebraic $\mu(\rho, R)$ (no global characteristic polynomial) as the cost of that reparameterization.

[**WITHDRAWN 2026-09-14**] Earlier versions of this subsection said more: that the product basis is *structurally incomplete*, that $\mu(\rho, R)$ is *irreducible* because that basis is "structurally blind to three-body coalescence," and that the reparameterization "accesses physics the algebraic product space cannot represent at any practical basis size." All of that rested on a saturation which has since been re-diagnosed, and none of it survives; the paragraphs below give the corrected reading and what it costs this taxonomy.

Level 4 combines the two-center complication of Level 2 with the two-electron complication of Level 3. Two approaches exist, with fundamentally different algebraic character.

The product-space approach (prolate spheroidal CI, Paper 12) is fully algebraic: all electron-electron matrix elements are computed from Neumann expansion recurrence relations with zero spatial quadrature. The Laguerre radial and Legendre angular matrix elements are likewise algebraic. In the σ sector no transcendental constant appears beyond the single one-dimensional quadrature Paper 12 records for its log-singular B_l moment; the $|m| \geq 1$ extension leaves that sector, as the scope note below states.

Paper 12's convergence study finds that this approach saturates at 92.4% of the exact dissociation energy D_e [5]: 92.37% at 46 basis functions and 92.42% at 72, the last near-tripling of the basis buying 0.34 mHa.

[**WITHDRAWN 2026-09-14**] Earlier versions quoted a finer ladder here ("92.5% at $l_{\max} = 4$, 114 basis functions", a decay "by a factor of 200", and an extrapolation predicting $l_{\max} \sim 45$ for 5% error) from an unpublished track note. That note has no permanent home, none of those figures is reproduced in Paper 12, and the extrapolation is in any case an extrapolation along the wrong axis—see below. They are withdrawn rather than re-sourced.

[**MEASURED 2026-09-14**] That saturation is real but it is a *σ-sector* saturation, and the extrapolation ran along the wrong axis. Track M scanned $l_{\max}$ in a φ-independent basis, which spans only $m_1 = m_2 = 0$; a ${}^1\Sigma_g^+$ state constrains only the *total* $M = m_1 + m_2$, so every π^2 and δ^2 configuration—which carry the angular correlation—was absent by construction. Opening that axis in the same basis, with the same Neumann kernel, reaches ∼99.1% of D_e (Paper 12 [5], Sec. "Restoring the Azimuthal Channels"). The σ axis does saturate—Paper 12's own convergence table buys 0.34 mHa for 2.7× the functions—but it saturates because it is the wrong axis, not because the product space is incomplete.

[**SCOPE**] That 99.1% is *not* obtained with the same *algebraic* V_{ee}: Paper 12's own scope note records that the $\mu > 0$ radial integrals leave the A_l, B_l, X_l recurrences for a two-dimensional spectral quadrature, so the quadrature-free property holds in the σ sector only.

[**OPEN**] Whether that departure carries *transcendental* content in this paper's sense is not settled here, and the question matters for the taxonomy. Paper 12 describes the quadrature as an implementation state rather than a structural obstruction—generalising the three auxiliary tables to associated Legendre functions is "well-defined but not attempted there"—which would make the $|m| \leq 1$ route carry no new exchange constant. The Level-2 analogue points the other way: opening $m \neq 0$ there is exactly how the embedding constant $e^a E_1(a)$ arises (Sec. II B), and the tier table's "(none)" entry for the prolate product space is a σ-sector entry with no counterpart row for $|m| \geq 1$. An earlier version of this paragraph asserted the first reading as though it were established; it is not, and the taxonomy owes this row a price or a proof that there is none.

The observation that looked like a smoking gun is explicit correlation: adding r_{12} factors to a small σ-only basis buys accuracy that many more σ functions do not. (Earlier versions quoted "94.7% with 9 functions" from an unpublished track note; that note has no permanent home and the figure is not reproduced in Paper 12, whose nearest comparison reports 86.8% with 18 r_{12}-bearing functions against 92.2% for the algebraic σ-only route. The qualitative point below does not depend on which run is quoted, so the specific number is withdrawn rather than repaired.) [**MEASURED 2026-09-14**] It is a real measurement and it points somewhere else than was read. An r_{12} factor supplies angular correlation, which is precisely what the absent $m \neq 0$ configurations were carrying; so does opening the azimuthal axis, and more cheaply still—54 functions at $|m| \leq 1$ reach 98.95%. Two different devices supplying the same missing ingredient is evidence about *what was missing*, not evidence that a basis without either is structurally deficient. The numerical coincidence between the residual 7.5% here and Paper 12's 7.6% is genuine, and both are now attributed to the same cause: the σ-only restriction. The transcorrelated approach (Paper 14, Sec. IV; Paper 15, Sec. VI.J) removes the $1/r_{12}$ singularity via a Jastrow similarity transformation, converting $1/r_{12}$ from a hard embedding constant to a smooth gradient operator at the cost of non-Hermiticity (Sec. IV).

The mol-frame hyperspherical reparameterization (Paper 15) introduces coordinates (ρ, R, α) where ρ is the electron hyperradius and α the hyperangle. The angu-

lar eigenvalues $\mu(\rho, R)$ are a function of *two* continuous parameters (piecewise-algebraic, below). That solver achieves 94.1% D_e at $l_{\max} = 4$ with σ and π channels. [**SCOPE**] Earlier versions read this as "surpassing the prolate CI ceiling." It is not a matched comparison—the 94.1% includes π channels and the 92.5% does not—and Paper 15 has withdrawn the coordinate-system reading it supported.

[**WITHDRAWN 2026-09-14**] Earlier versions closed here with a *qualitative* distinction between Levels 3 and 4: that at Level 3 $\mu(R)$ is a computational convenience while at Level 4 $\mu(\rho, R)$ is *irreducible*, because the product basis "saturates" and is "structurally blind to three-body coalescence." The saturation was the σ-only restriction, so that distinction has lost its evidence and is withdrawn.

[**OBSERVATION**] What stands in its place is a *structural* distinction, which is independent of the withdrawn one and survives it intact. At Level 3 the angular Hamiltonian is a linear matrix pencil, so $\mu(R)$ satisfies a global characteristic polynomial $P(R, \mu) = 0$ and is an *algebraic* function over $\mathbb{Q}(\pi, \sqrt{2})$—pointwise diagonalisation there is computational convenience, not necessity (Sec. II C and Sec. VII E; Track P1). At Level 4 the split-region Legendre expansion breaks the pencil, and $\mu(\rho, R)$ is piecewise-algebraic with *no* global characteristic polynomial (Track S). That is what separates the two levels in this taxonomy, and it is why the table below tiers them differently—"alg. (implicit)" against "piecewise."

[**WITHDRAWN**] An earlier version of this paragraph said instead that both constants are "genuinely transcendental ... with no known algebraic replacement," citing the project's algebraic registry. That is the *negation* of what the registry and Sec. II C both state for $\mu(R)$, and it is withdrawn. What is true of both is narrower: neither has been shown *necessary* for the energy, so neither earns the label irreducible on completeness grounds.

[**OPEN**] What fell is the *completeness* sense of irreducibility—that the product space cannot represent the physics. Two other irreducibility results for Level 4 are untouched and should not be read as withdrawn with it: the geometric-elevation obstruction recorded under "Irreducibility of the Level 4 piecewise structure" below (three routes ruled out), and the structural one just stated (no global $P(\rho, \mu)$, Track S). What is now open is narrower: whether any Level-4 exchange constant is necessary for the *energy*. Answering it would require a product-space calculation that converges, or provably fails to converge, with the azimuthal axis open—which the $|m| \leq 1$ result begins but does not finish, since $|m| = 2$ was not obtained there.

E. Level 5: Spectral-side exchange constants on S^3

Four further realizations of the taxonomy live on the same S^3 substrate as Levels 1–4 but classify projections of *spectral* rather than basis-level data: a closed-form Dirichlet L-content identity in the Dirac Dirichlet difference; a GUE/Poisson dichotomy between the spectral-zeta and Ihara-zeta sides of the framework; an algebraic-but-non-radical tier produced by a non-solvable Galois factor of the Ihara zeta on S^5; and an α^2-weighted Ihara zeta living in the ring $\mathbb{Q}(\alpha^2)[s]$. All four are catalogued here as new entries in the basis-level catalog of Levels 1–4; their meta-pattern (categorical disagreement between spectral and combinatorial views of the same Dirac data) is treated in Sec. VIII.

a. Closed-form χ_{-4} content in the Dirac Dirichlet difference. On S^3 with the Camporesi–Higuchi Dirac spectrum $|\lambda_n| = n+3/2$ and degeneracy $g_n = 2(n+1)(n+2)$, define the Dirac Dirichlet series $D(s) = \sum_n g_n/|\lambda_n|^s$ and its vertex-parity split $D_{\text{even}}(s)$, $D_{\text{odd}}(s)$ (Paper 28 [13], eqs. (3)–(5)). The difference has the exact closed form

$$D_{\text{even}}(s) - D_{\text{odd}}(s) \;=\; 2^{s-1}\,\big(\beta(s) - \beta(s-2)\big), \quad s \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 2}, \tag{7}$$

where $\beta(s) = L(s, \chi_{-4})$ is the Dirichlet L-function of the mod-4 character. Two elementary Hurwitz identities drive the collapse: $\zeta(s, 5/4) = \zeta(s, 1/4) - 4^s$ and $\zeta(s, 3/4) = \zeta(s, 1/4) - 4^s\beta(s)$. Verified by sympy symbolic identity at $s \in \{2, \ldots, 10, 15\}$ and by PSLQ at 100-digit precision (`debug/spectral_chi_neg4_memo.md`). Eq. (7) is the concrete realization of Paper 28's qualitative "vertex parity acts as χ_{-4}" statement: the Dirichlet L-content enters the spectral-Dirichlet difference as a closed-form linear combination of $\beta(s)$ and $\beta(s-2)$ with integer prefactor 2^{s-1}.

b. RMT-spacing without critical-line confinement: the spectral–Ihara dichotomy. The zeros of $D(s)$, $D_{\text{even}}(s)$, $D_{\text{odd}}(s)$ in the strip $\text{Im}(s) \in [0, 70]$ have unfolded imaginary-part spacing coefficient of variation CV $\in \{0.348, 0.343, 0.396\}$ —consistent with GUE (CV $\approx$ 0.46) and inconsistent with Poisson (CV $\approx$ 1.05). Kolmogorov–Smirnov testing rejects Poisson at $p = 0.004, 0.030$ respectively and cannot reject GUE. This is the first GUE signature in the GeoVac framework, and it is confined to the *spectral* Dirichlet side only: the combinatorial / Ihara-zeta side (graph non-backtracking walks) has Poisson / Berry-Tabor spacing at CV ≈ 1, a categorical dichotomy. Equally important, the $D(s)$ zeros are *not* on a single critical line (they are scattered in $\text{Re}(s) \in [2.02, 3.42]$), so the GUE signature is a spacing-only statement, not an RH-style line constraint: classical ζ has *both* RMT spacing and critical-line confinement; GeoVac's spectral zeta has only the first. This creates a new taxonomic tier, *RMT-spacing without critical-line confinement*.

c. Algebraic-but-non-radical transcendental content. The integer-coefficient Ihara-zeta factorizations produced in Paper 29 [14] factor over specific number fields as follows. Cyclotomic factors Φ_3, Φ_4, Φ_6 have Galois group $\mathbb{Z}/2$ (abelian); they fingerprint specific graph cycles (e.g. $\Phi_3, \Phi_6 \leftrightarrow$ 3-prism cycles of the $\ell = 1$ Coulomb S^3 component). Ramanujan-boundary factors $(4s^2+1)^2$ and $(9s^2+1)^4$ live in $\mathbb{Q}(i)$, consistent with the Hopf $\mathbb{Z}_2$

m-reflection sub-action of the Paper 25 Hopf $U(1)$ (see Observation 2 of [14]). *Bulk* factors have non-abelian Galois groups: S_3 for scalar S^3 cubics; S_4 for the Dirac-S^3 Rule-A $n_{\max} = 3$ quartic; and crucially S_6 (non-solvable) for the factor $P_{12}(s^2)$ in the scalar S^5 $N_{\max} = 3$ Ihara zeta. By Abel–Ruffini, the 12 zeros of P_{12} have *no radical expression* over $\mathbb{Q}$; by Kronecker–Weber, they do not lie in any cyclotomic extension $\mathbb{Q}(\zeta_M)$. This places a new tier in Sec. IV's output-class axis: *algebraic but not radical* — intermediate between closed-form radical algebraic and classical periods.

d. α^2-weighted Ihara zeta in the ring $\mathbb{Q}(\alpha^2)[s]$. The unweighted Ihara zeta depends only on 0/1 graph connectivity. Introducing the edge weighting $w(a,b) = 1 + \alpha^2 \cdot |f_{\rm SO}(a) + f_{\rm SO}(b)|/2$, where $f_{\rm SO}(n,\kappa) = -(\kappa+1)/[4n^3\ell(\ell+1/2)(\ell+1)]$ is the dimensionless Breit–Pauli spin-orbit diagonal, gives a weighted Ihara zeta $\zeta_G^w(s)$ living in the ring $\mathbb{Q}(\alpha^2)[s]$ — an explicit realization of the spinor-intrinsic tier without the $\gamma = \sqrt{1-(Z\alpha)^2}$ radical (`geovac/ihara_zeta_weighted.py`; the module's 14 tests cover the weighted-Ihara infrastructure; the degree-44 / $-35/648$ values below are checked by an independent modular determinant in `tests/test_paper18_computed_pins.py`). For Rule-A at $n_{\max} = 3$, the inverse zeta expands as a polynomial in α of degree 44, with α^2 coefficient carrying the clean rational prefactor $-35/648$. The coefficient is a graph-invariant, not an edge-local perturbation — a concrete α^2-content projection.

Taxonomic placement of the Level-5 realizations

The four Level-5 constants slot into the existing taxonomy as follows. The χ_{-4} identity (7) is a *calibration*-tier exchange constant of the infinite-spectral-sum sub-case (earlier drafts called this sub-case "flow"; it is not a separate tier of Sec. IV), with the novelty that its value is an integer-coefficient linear combination of classical Dirichlet L-values, so Paper 18's transcendental taxonomy gains a "Dirichlet-L-closed" cell at the intersection of the infinite-spectral-sum calibration sub-case and Dirac-spectrum projection. The GUE-vs-Poisson dichotomy is a *meta-level* discriminant, not itself a transcendental, but classifies spectral objects by zero statistics — a new axis in Sec. IV. The algebraic-but-non-radical tier from P_{12} is a new *intrinsic* exchange-constant sub-class between Level 0 (rational/integer) and classical periods; it is the first time a non-solvable Galois group has been exhibited as a framework-native transcendental class. The α^2-weighted zeta is a *spinor-intrinsic* exchange constant in the ring $\mathbb{Q}(\alpha^2)[s]$, a subring of the full spinor-intrinsic tier $\mathbb{Q}(\alpha^2)[\gamma]/(\gamma^2+(Z\alpha)^2-1)$ introduced in Sec. IV.

III. THE PATTERN: WEYL–SELBERG EXCHANGE

A. Weyl's law

The mathematical content of the observations in Sec. II is an instance of Weyl's law, which states that the eigenvalue counting function $N(\lambda)$ of the Laplace–Beltrami operator on a compact Riemannian manifold of dimension d satisfies [28]

$$N(\lambda) \sim \frac{\omega_d}{(2\pi)^d}\,\mathrm{vol}(\Omega)\,\lambda^{d/2} \qquad (\lambda \to \infty), \tag{8}$$

where $\omega_d = \pi^{d/2}/\Gamma(d/2+1)$ is the volume of the unit ball in $\mathbb{R}^d$.

Weyl's law relates two fundamentally different descriptions of the same manifold:

- The **spectral side**: $N(\lambda)$, a discrete staircase function counting integer-labeled eigenvalues.
- The **geometric side**: $\mathrm{vol}(\Omega)$, a continuous quantity measured by integration over the manifold.

The conversion factor $\omega_d/(2\pi)^d$ involves $\pi^{d/2}$—a transcendental that depends only on the dimension. This factor is the prototypical *spectral-geometric exchange constant*: it converts between counting (discrete) and measuring (continuous).

For the specific manifolds in the GeoVac hierarchy, the ball volumes ω_d carry $\pi^{\lfloor d/2 \rfloor}$:

- S^1 ($d=1$): $\omega_1 = 2$, Weyl constant $\omega_1/(2\pi)^1 = 1/\pi$.
- S^2 ($d=2$): $\omega_2 = \pi$, Weyl constant $\omega_2/(2\pi)^2 = 1/(4\pi)$.
- S^3 ($d=3$): $\omega_3 = 4\pi/3$, Weyl constant $\omega_3/(2\pi)^3 = 1/(6\pi^2)$.
- S^5 ($d=5$): $\omega_5 = 8\pi^2/15$, Weyl constant $\omega_5/(2\pi)^5 = 1/(60\pi^3)$.

In each case, the Weyl constant involves inverse powers of π (specifically $\pi^{-\lceil d/2 \rceil}$), reflecting the transcendental cost of converting a discrete eigenvalue count into a continuous volume measure.

B. Compactness as the source of discreteness

The Peter–Weyl theorem [33] states that the unitary representations of a compact Lie group form a discrete, countable, orthogonal decomposition of $L^2(G)$. This is why quantum numbers are integers: SO(4) is compact, so its irreps are labeled by discrete indices (n,l,m) with finite multiplicities $g_n = n^2$. Exchange constants arise when these discrete representations are expressed in non-compact coordinate systems—the stereographic $S^3 \to \mathbb{R}^3$ introduces the energy-shell scale $p_0^2 = -2E$ (the matched

κ fixes only the graph's band edge, and its coincidence with the Fock Jacobian is an Observation); embedding in prolate spheroidal coordinates introduces $e^a E_1(a)$; reparameterizing $S^3 \times S^3$ as hyperspherical introduces $\mu(R)$. The transcendental content is the toll for crossing the compactness boundary.

a. Attribution, and the precise form of the claim. The reading that compactness is the *source* of spectral discreteness is not original here, and we do not claim it. It is stated causally for the gauge group of loop quantum gravity by Liu and Noui [34]—"the discreteness of the quantum geometry ... can be interpreted as a direct consequence of the compactness (via Harmonic analysis) of the residual symmetry group $SU(2)$"—and their same paper exhibits the converse, non-compact $SU(1,1)$ yielding continuous time-like area spectra. Earlier and more generally, Rovelli's first postulate for relational quantum mechanics reads "relevant information is finite for a system with compact phase space," from which, he notes, "the characteristic discreteness of quantum theory" follows [35]. In mathematics the statement is older still and owned three times over: Pontryagin duality (compact $\Leftrightarrow$ discrete dual), Peter–Weyl, and the compact-resolvent characterization built into Connes' spectral-triple axioms.

The claim must also be stated in the right form, because the slogan "discreteness *is* compactness" is false as a biconditional over *spaces*. Maz'ya and Shubin [36] give sharp necessary and sufficient conditions under which a Schrödinger operator on non-compact $\mathbb{R}^n$ has purely discrete spectrum; a confining potential suffices, and the harmonic oscillator is the standing counterexample—an object this program uses in its own right (Paper 24). The correct general statement is at the level of the *operator*, not the space: discrete spectrum with finite multiplicities is equivalent to compactness of the resolvent. Compactness of the underlying group or manifold is a sufficient mechanism, and it is the one operative for S^3; it is not necessary in general.

What this paper adds to the above is therefore not the mechanism but the *accounting*: the claim that each released axis carries an identifiable transcendental price, and that those prices can be classified by operator order and bundle type (Sec. III E). Weyl's constant $\omega_d/(2\pi)^d$ is universally known; we have not found it read as a toll paid per decompactified direction, nor the physics statement joined to its number-theoretic converse, that every period is the volume of a compact semi-algebraic set.

C. π as the founding example

The simplest spectral-geometric exchange constant is π itself. The Laplacian on S^1 (the circle) has eigenvalues n^2, counted by integers; the continuous circumference is 2π. The conversion between the discrete eigenvalue count and the continuous measure is mediated by π. More generally, the volume of the unit d-sphere involves $\pi^{d/2}$, and the Weyl constant $\omega_d/(2\pi)^d$ carries exactly this factor. Every exchange constant in the GeoVac hierarchy is a descendant of this primordial example: the calibration π of the S^3 projection inherits from the S^3 Weyl constant (κ itself is rational and matched, so it inherits nothing), the Stieltjes seed involves the exponential integral (a function whose Taylor coefficients involve the Euler–Mascheroni constant, itself a limit of harmonic sums weighted by π-dependent terms), and $\mu(R)$ is an eigenvalue of a Hamiltonian on S^5 whose Weyl asymptotics carry $\pi^{5/2}$.

Observation 1 (The graph is π-free)**.** *Every algebraic operation in the GeoVac graph construction produces integers, rationals, or algebraic numbers—never a transcendental:*

- *The graph Laplacian itself has integer matrix entries, so its eigenvalues are algebraic (roots of an integer characteristic polynomial). They are generally* irrational*: the graph is block diagonal in ℓ with each block a product of two paths, so its spectrum is the set of sums $\left(2-2\cos\frac{j\pi}{n_{\max}-\ell}\right)+\left(2-2\cos\frac{k\pi}{2\ell+1}\right)$ (Paper 0 §VI), e.g. $2-\sqrt{2}$; cosines of rational multiples of π are algebraic, so no transcendental enters.*

- *The Laplace–Beltrami spectrum $\lambda_n = -(n^2-1)$ of the* continuum *S^3 operator: integer for all n. This is not the graph's own spectrum (which is bounded in $[0,8]$); it acts on the graph's* label set *as the diagonal $SO(4)$ Casimir, and the graph's edge Laplacian does* not *converge to it (it splits into $n_{\max}$ disconnected ℓ-blocks, Paper 0 §VI; corrected 2026-09-28 from "indicated numerically, not established").*

- *Degeneracies: $g_n = n^2$, integer.*

- *Gaunt integrals (Legendre normalization, $\int P_{l_1} P_k P_{l_2}\, dx$): ratios of factorials via Wigner $3j$ symbols, rational.*

- *Selection rules: combinatorial (triangle inequality on angular momentum labels).*

- *Clebsch–Gordan coefficients: algebraic numbers (square roots of rationals).*

- *Casimir eigenvalues: $l(l+1)$, $\nu(\nu+4)/2$, integer or half-integer for all levels.*

Transcendental numbers (π, $e^a E_1(a)$, $\zeta(2)$) enter exclusively through normalization to continuous measures: $\int |Y|^2\, d\Omega = 1$ (with $d\Omega$ carrying 4π), $\mathrm{vol}(S^3) = 2\pi^2$, and spectral zeta functions. The exchange constants are precisely the π-injection points.

D. The Selberg trace formula

Weyl's law is asymptotic. The Selberg trace formula [29] provides the exact identity:

$$\sum_j h(r_j) = \frac{\mathrm{Area}(\Gamma\backslash\mathcal{H})}{4\pi}\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} r\,\tanh(\pi r)\,h(r)\,dr + \sum_{\{\gamma\}}\cdots \tag{9}$$

where the left side sums over the discrete spectrum, the first term on the right involves the continuous volume (with a factor of π), and subsequent terms sum over conjugacy classes (geodesics). The Selberg trace formula is the bridge between the spectral world and the geometric world, and the transcendental factors (π, tanh, logarithms of algebraic numbers) are the toll for crossing.

When the quotient $\Gamma\backslash G$ is compact, the spectrum is purely discrete and the trace formula involves only algebraic data plus π-dependent conversion factors. When the quotient is non-compact, a continuous spectrum appears and the exchange involves Eisenstein series [29]. This parallels the GeoVac hierarchy: Level 1 (compact S^3) requires only a constant (the energy-shell scale p_0; the matched κ is a rational band-edge scale, not a carrier of the spectrum); Level 3 involves an algebraic function $\mu(R)$ with transcendental coefficients (Sec. VII E).

E. The Mellin transform as the taxonomic engine

The preceding subsections identify the *what*—compact-to-non-compact projection introduces transcendental content—and the *where*—Weyl's law and the Selberg trace formula are the structural bridges. Here we identify the *how*: the Mellin transform of the heat kernel trace is the single mathematical operation that converts the discrete spectral data of a compact manifold into the transcendental content tagged in Sec. IV.

For a non-negative self-adjoint operator A on a compact Riemannian manifold, the spectral zeta function is related to the heat kernel trace by [44, 45]

$$\zeta_A(s) \;=\; \frac{1}{\Gamma(s)}\int_0^\infty t^{s-1}\;\mathrm{Tr}\big(e^{-tA}\big)\,dt\,, \tag{10}$$

where $\mathrm{Tr}(e^{-tA}) = \sum_n g_n\, e^{-t\lambda_n}$ is a purely spectral object: the sum runs over the discrete eigenvalues λ_n with their integer degeneracies g_n. Both sides of Eq. (10) encode the same information—the spectrum of A—but on the left in a form that produces transcendental numbers ($\pi^{d/2}$ from the Seeley–DeWitt asymptotic expansion of the heat trace, odd-zeta values from the analytic continuation), and on the right in a form that is manifestly a function of integer-labeled eigenvalues and degeneracies. The Mellin transform is the bridge; the $\Gamma(s)$ prefactor is the conversion toll.

a. Operator order determines the Mellin output class. The three-axis taxonomy of QED transcendentals on S^3 (Sec. IV) has its foundation in the distinction between applying the Mellin transform to the squared eigenvalues λ_n^2 versus the raw eigenvalues $|\lambda_n|$.

For the *squared* Dirac operator D^2 on unit S^3, the eigenvalues are $(n+3/2)^2$, which are perfect squares of half-integers. The heat trace $\mathrm{Tr}(e^{-tD^2})$ is a theta-function-like object whose Mellin transform samples only even powers: the variable substitution $m = 2n+3$ converts the spectral sum to a sum over odd integers, and the Euler–Bernoulli formula for $\zeta_R(2k)$ maps every term to rational $\times\,\pi^{2k}$. This is the content of the T9 theorem (Paper 28, Theorem 1 [13]): $\zeta_{D^2}(s)$ is a two-term polynomial in π^2 at every integer s. At integer s no odd-zeta value can appear because $\zeta_{D^2}(s) = D(2s)$ samples only even arguments: the squaring operation has removed the odd-power structure from the Mellin integrand; at half-integer $s \geq 5/2$ odd zeta values do appear (Paper 28).

For the *first-order* Dirac operator $|D|$ with eigenvalues $n+3/2$, the Mellin transform accesses the raw half-integer spectrum. The Dirac Dirichlet series $D(s) = \sum g_n|\lambda_n|^{-s}$ involves both even and odd powers of the spectral parameter, and the parity discriminant (Paper 28, Theorem 2 [13]) follows directly: at even s, both constituent Hurwitz zeta terms are Bernoulli-type (π^{even}); at odd s, both involve odd-zeta values, conjecturally independent of π (period conjecture). The operator order—first versus second—determines whether the Mellin transform samples the raw spectrum or its square, and this single distinction generates the first axis of the three-axis classification.

b. Interaction deforms the heat kernel. A potential V added to a free operator A deforms its heat kernel. (On S^3 the Coulomb term is not such a perturbation: Fock's projection absorbs it, making the bound-state Hamiltonian a function of Δ_{S^3}, Paper 7.) In the heat kernel framework, the perturbed trace $\mathrm{Tr}(e^{-t(A+V)})$ has an asymptotic expansion whose Seeley–DeWitt coefficients $a_k(A+V)$ differ from the free coefficients $a_k(A)$ by terms involving the potential and its derivatives [46]. The Mellin transform of this perturbed heat trace produces spectral zeta values that access transcendental content beyond the π-polynomial ring of the free operator. (For the *free* Dirac operator D on unit S^3, the SD expansion terminates at exactly two terms by the Jacobi theta modular identity: $\mathrm{Tr}\, e^{-tD^2} = (\sqrt{\pi}/2)\,t^{-3/2} - (\sqrt{\pi}/4)\,t^{-1/2} + O(e^{-\pi^2/t})$, with $a_k = 0$ for $k \geq 2$; interaction opens the full MZV algebra.)

The Sommerfeld fine-structure sums $D_p = \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} c_p(n)$ (Paper 28, Sec. 7 [13]) are precisely the perturbative expansion of this effect. At each order p in $(Z\alpha)^{2p}$, the coefficients $c_p(n)$ involve generalized harmonic numbers $H_{n-1}^{(r)}$, which are partial Euler sums that access the full Euler–Zagier multiple zeta value (MZV) algebra. The free heat kernel produces only π^{even} at integer s (Bernoulli); the Coulomb interaction opens the door to odd-zeta values ($\zeta_R(3)$ at $p=2$, $\zeta_R(5)$ and $\zeta_R(7)$ at $p=3$, and so on) and to products of zeta values at higher orders.

This maps directly onto the exchange constant taxonomy:

- **Intrinsic tier** (angular/Gaunt structure): no Mellin transform is needed; the result is purely rational.
- **Calibration tier** (π, $\zeta_R(2)$; the matched κ is rational and is not a Mellin output): Mellin transform of the *free* heat kernel on the compact manifold $\to \pi^{\text{even}}$ exclusively at integer s.
- **Embedding tier** (cusp, $1/r_{12}$, Sommerfeld D_p): Mellin transform of the *interaction-deformed* heat kernel $\to$ the full MZV algebra.

c. The product survival rule as a Mellin selection rule. The product survival rule (Paper 28 [13])—the systematic cancellation of $\zeta(2) \times \zeta(\text{odd})$ products at every Sommerfeld order—has a natural interpretation in this framework. The n^2 Fock degeneracy that weights the Sommerfeld sums is the same n^2 that produces $F = \zeta_R(2) = D_{n^2}(4)$ in the free-geometry Mellin output (Paper 2 [8], Phase 4F identification). When the interaction-deformed Mellin transform generates product terms $\zeta(a) \times \zeta(b)$, the Fock-degeneracy weighting acts as a selection rule: products involving $\zeta(2)$ are systematically expelled because $\zeta(2)$ is already "used" as the Fock Dirichlet evaluation F, and the n^2 weighting enforces orthogonality between the free and interacting Mellin outputs.

d. K–Sommerfeld separation as a Mellin consequence. The K–Sommerfeld structural separation (Paper 28 [13])—the PSLQ-verified fact that K/π is not in the $\mathbb{Q}$-span of $\{D_2, \ldots, D_6, 1\}$—is a direct consequence of the Mellin framework. The ingredients of $K = \pi(B+F-\Delta)$ are all *free-geometry* Mellin invariants: B is a truncated trace of the free Casimir, $F = \zeta_R(2)$ is the spectral zeta of the free Fock-degeneracy Dirichlet series at $s = d_{\max}$, and $\Delta^{-1} = g_3^{\text{Dirac}}$ is a single-level mode count of the free Dirac operator. All three live in the π-polynomial ring guaranteed by Eq. (21). The Sommerfeld D_p, by contrast, are Mellin transforms of the *Coulomb-perturbed* heat kernel, dressed with harmonic numbers that access the full MZV algebra. The two sets of quantities inhabit different rings because they are Mellin transforms at different perturbative orders: K at zeroth order (free geometry), D_p at p-th order (interacting geometry).

e. Summary. The Mellin transform (10) is the silent engine of the entire exchange constant taxonomy. It converts discrete spectral data (integer eigenvalues, integer degeneracies) into transcendental content (π, $\zeta(s)$, Dirichlet L-values), and the *class* of transcendental that emerges is determined by three properties of the operator whose heat kernel is being transformed: (1) whether it is first- or second-order (controlling the motivic weight of the Mellin output); (2) whether it acts on scalars or spinors (modulating rational coefficients); and (3) whether the potential is free or interaction-deformed (controlling whether the output stays in the π-polynomial ring or accesses the full MZV algebra). These are precisely the three axes of the QED transcendental taxonomy formalized in Sec. IV.

f. Period-ring stratification of the master Mellin engine (June 2026 closure). The master Mellin engine partition $\mathcal{M}[\mathrm{Tr}(D^k e^{-tD^2})]$ with $k \in \{0, 1, 2\}$ admits a period-theoretic stratification over the cases the conditional case-exhaustion theorem treats (first fifteen Paper 34 projections; M2 for Seeley–DeWitt coefficients and integer s), established by three companion sprints in June 2026 (memos `debug/sprint_m1_pure_tate_memo.md`, `debug/sprint_mixed_tate_test_memo.md`, `debug/sprint_m3_cyclotomic_mixed_tate_memo.md`):

$$M_1 \subset \mathbb{Q}[\pi, \pi^{-1}], \qquad M_2 \subset \bigoplus_{k \geq 0} \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}, \qquad M_3 \subset \mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z}[i, 1/2]) \text{ at l} \tag{11}$$

indexed by the operator-order slot k. M1 ($k = 0$ volume slot, $\mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/4 = \pi$) generates the localised pure-Tate algebra at π; M2 (Seeley–DeWitt heat-kernel coefficients) inherits the Fathizadeh–Marcolli [48] mixed-Tate classification of spectral-action expansions on Robertson–Walker spacetimes, with a pure-Tate refinement on the static S^3 sub-case (no $\zeta(3), \zeta(5)$, or MZV content at the SD level); M3 (vertex-parity sums producing Hurwitz at quarter-integer shifts and Dirichlet L-values including Catalan $G = \beta(2)$ and $\beta(4)$) inherits the Deligne [49] + Glanois [50] cyclotomic mixed-Tate classification at level 4, with the vertex-parity-as-χ_{-4} correspondence realising the Deligne–Glanois Galois descent from level 4 to level 2 on the framework's natural QED observables.

Paper 32 §VIII Corollaries `cor:m1_pure_tate`, `cor:m2_mixed_tate`, and `cor:m3_cyclotomic_mixed_tate` state the case-exhaustion-theorem-level consequences. Every transcendental in the census of GeoVac spectral data has a named motivic home (a census, not a classification; indexing by the Mellin slot k is a reading, with the period-ring tie-break stated below for a value reached from two slots); the remainder of this subsection walks the master-mechanism reading (§ master-mechanism), the mechanism-as-domain reading (§ domain-partition), the witness panels for the three period-ring closures (§§ Mixed-Tate / M3-cyclotomic / M1-pure-Tate), and the remaining open questions (sectional convention; non-compact rate; discrete c_1).

g. Master-mechanism reading (Track TS-E3, May 2026). The Mellin engine reading admits a sharper structural statement. The spectral-triple framing of GeoVac (Paper 32) admits a candidate case-exhaustion theorem (Paper 32 Theorem on π-source case-exhaustion, **[CONDITIONAL]**, first fifteen Paper 34 projections): every π in such a chain arises from one of three named mechanisms M1 ($k = 0$ volume slot), M2 (Seeley–DeWitt heat-kernel coefficient), or M3 (vertex-topology Hurwitz Dirichlet L-content). Track TS-E3's falsification sweep against three candidate

fourth mechanisms (continuum gravity, anomaly classes, non-trivial principal bundles) returned a stronger structural finding: M1, M2, M3 are not three independent mechanisms but *three sub-cases of a single master mechanism* parameterized by operator order:

$$\pi\text{-source} = \mathcal{M}\Big[\mathrm{Tr}(D^k \cdot e^{-tD^2})\Big](s) \quad \text{with} \quad k \in \{0,1,2\}. \tag{12}$$

The three sub-cases correspond to: $k = 0$ (trivial heat kernel on a sphere collapses to a volume factor $\mathrm{Vol}(S^d)$, recovering M1 — the historical name "Hopf-base measure" denotes this $k = 0$ volume slot and *not* a base-to-total ratio of the Hopf fibration, a distinction that matters wherever the name is read as a ratio (2026-09-03; Paper 38, volume-ratio note)); $k = 2$ (standard spectral action $\mathrm{Tr}\, f(D^2/\Lambda^2)$ generates Seeley–DeWitt coefficients, recovering M2); and $k = 1$ (the plain trace $\mathrm{Tr}(D \cdot e^{-tD^2})$ vanishes on the symmetric Camporesi–Higuchi spectrum; the slot is read through the absolute sum and its vertex-parity grading, Eq. (14), which gives the quarter-integer Hurwitz shifts, recovering M3). The Mellin engine of this section is therefore not just *a* mechanism producing exchange constants; under the (conditional) case-exhaustion theorem, it is the *master* mechanism through which π enters where it does, with operator order k selecting the sub-mechanism. The first-vs. second-order axis named above (motivic weight) is exactly the $k = 1$ vs. $k = 2$ split; the $k = 0$ free-Mellin case is the volume slot singled out by Paper 25.

h. Mechanism-as-domain reading (Sprint MR-A/B/C, May 2026). The master Mellin engine reading admits a further refinement when read in the *predictive* direction. The formal statement of the sharpening appears as a remark accompanying the case-exhaustion theorem in Paper 32 § VIII [16]; what follows is the operational summary that closes Paper 18's taxonomic engine. A three-track sprint sequence (MR-A: Dirac state-space GH rate; MR-B: spectral-action modular residual; MR-C: L2 next-order constant) tested whether the engine predicts the transcendental ring of a convergence rate from the operator order k of the underlying mechanism.

Sprint MR-B obtained the M2 modular residual in closed form. The Camporesi–Higuchi heat kernel on the half-integer Dirac spectrum admits a Jacobi ϑ_2 modular decomposition

$$\varepsilon(t) \;=\; \sum_{m\geq 1} (-1)^m \sqrt{\pi}\, e^{-m^2\pi^2/t} \left[t^{-3/2} - 2m^2\pi^2 t^{-5/2} - \tfrac{1}{2} t^{-1/2}\right] \tag{13}$$

verified to > 100 digits at every tested t. Every coefficient is an overall $\sqrt{\pi}$ (the standard heat-trace normalisation, from the $(4\pi t)^{-3/2}$ prefactor) times an element of the pure-Tate M2 ring $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$; the modular exponent is exactly π^2. The leading prefactor $2\pi^{5/2}$, the subleading $-\sqrt{\pi}\, t$, and the $\frac{1}{2}\sqrt{\pi}\, t^2$ correction at the next order are all in M2.

Sprint MR-A computed the natural Dirac analog of the SU(2) scalar central Fejér moment, which bounds the state-space GH distance (Paper 38; a kernel constant, not the convergence rate, since a tapered amplitude gives $O(1/n)$). The scalar baseline (L2 sprint) had pinned the asymptote to $\lim_{n\to\infty} n\gamma_n/\log n = 4/\pi$ ([**INTERNAL THEOREM + MEASURED**]) with a uniform bound $\gamma_n \leq 6\,(\log n)/n$ checked on a finite range ([**MEASURED**]) (dual-Coxeter normalisation of the SU(2) metric, the rule $\mathrm{Cas}(\mathrm{ad}) = h^\vee$ under which the geodesic distance is the rotation angle; $2/\pi$ on the unit S^3, Paper 38). The constant is the sphere-volume quotient $\mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/\mathrm{Vol}(S^3) = 2/\pi$ for unit-radius spheres (twice that in the dual-Coxeter normalisation), which is consistent with the $k = 0$ slot's volume content and with $\mathbb{Q}[\pi, \pi^{-1}]$ membership — though an arithmetic identity between the Fejér first moment and a pair of sphere volumes corroborates the *slot tag*, not the mechanism, and $\mathbb{Q}[\pi, \pi^{-1}]$ membership follows from $4/\pi$ being a rational multiple of π^{-1} whatever its origin. What the name gets wrong is narrower: read as the Hopf fibration's *base-to-total ratio* it is a misnomer, since the Hopf map is a Riemannian submersion $S^3(r) \to S^2(r/2)$ and that ratio is $1/(2\pi)$, not $2/\pi$ (Paper 38, volume-ratio note). Read instead as the $k = 0$ volume factor, it carries the M1 volume content in closed form (a reading, not a derivation; Paper 38). The Dirac analog instead obtained the structural identity $\gamma_n^{\mathrm{Dirac}} = \pi$ for every $n_{\max} \geq 1$: the half-integer-only Peter–Weyl truncation cannot span the constant function χ_0, so the kernel does not localize at the identity, and no asymptotic decay exists to PSLQ. The scalar Fejér moment's decay is in fact an integer×half-integer interference effect; removing the integer-spin sector kills it. This is consistent with the M1 reading when the relevant sub-bundle lacks χ_0, and its presence in the scalar case is what the derived $4/\pi$ asymptote records.

Sprint MR-C extracted the L2 next-order constant c in $n \cdot \gamma_n^{\mathrm{scalar}} \sim (4/\pi)\log(n) + c + O(\log(n)/n)$ ($c = 4.109321467489875620422 9\ldots$, 22 verified decimal digits), and ran PSLQ at coefficient ceiling 10^4 against M1, M2, M3 and the extended ring $\{\gamma_E, \log 2, G, \zeta(3)\}$. No identification was returned.

The combined verdict reads:

> *Mechanism-as-domain partition.* The index $k \in \{0,1,2\}$ is read (a reading, not a derivation) as indexing both the M-mechanism and the natural domain of observable from which its signature can be extracted:
>
> - $k = 0$ (M1, volume slot): volume-slot normalizations; the SU(2) Fejér-moment constant shares the value (a reading, not a derivation, Paper 38): $4/\pi = \mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/\pi^2$ (dual-Coxeter convention; $2/\pi$ on the unit S^3), a kernel constant and not the GH convergence rate.
> - $k = 2$ (M2, Seeley–DeWitt): heat-kernel and spectral-action convergence; signature $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$ (after the standard $\sqrt{\pi}$ heat-trace

normalisation is divided out) throughout the modular residual (13).

- $k = 1$ (M3, vertex-topology Hurwitz): vertex-restricted parity-character spectral sums; signature Dirichlet $\beta(s)$ content via the closed-form identity $D_{\text{even}}(s) - D_{\text{odd}}(s) = 2^{s-1}(\beta(s) - \beta(s-2))$ (Paper 28 Theorem 3 [13]); witnessed in Paper 28 § QED-vertex (Catalan G, $\beta(4)$) but *not* in state-space GH rates.

Mixing the index of the question (e.g. "state-space GH rate") with the index of the mechanism ("vertex parity") produces structural degeneracy: this is exactly what MR-A measured. MR-C's negative is consistent with the same reading: the L2 subleading constant is downstream (via a Stein–Weiss IBP) of the M1-read Fejér constant, not a direct $\mathcal{M}[\mathrm{Tr}(D^k \cdot e^{-tD^2})]$, and the engine does not commit to the rings of derivative quantities along subsequent analytical pipelines. Within each domain the engine organizes the observed values (for $k = 0$ the domain is the Fejér kernel's moment, read as M1, not the GH rate; Paper 38). Source memos: `debug/mr_{a,b,c}_*_memo.md`, data `debug/data/mr_{a,b,c}_*.json`.

Sprint Q5'-Stage1-2b (June 2026, `debug/sprint_q5p_2b_phi0_mellin_memo.md`) sharpens the M_1 sub-mechanism's π injection further: on a compact 3-dimensional spectral triple, the $k = 0$ volume-slot π enters the formal Mellin transform $\Gamma(s) \cdot \zeta_{D^2}(s)$ specifically at the spectral-dimension pole $s = d/2 = 3/2$ via the Weyl-law short-time leading $\mathrm{Tr}(e^{-tD^2}) \sim \sqrt{\pi}/2 \cdot t^{-d/2}$; at every finite truncation $n_{\max}$ the spectral zeta itself is rational-valued, and the master-Mellin transcendentals appear only in the continuum analytic-continuation step. This localizes the M_1 sub-mechanism's natural domain to the non-integer spectral-dimension residue of the cochain-level Mellin transform. The same-day continuum follow-on (Sprint Q5'-Stage1-2b-continuum, `debug/sprint_q5p_continuum_mellin_memo.md`) computes the Mellin residue exactly: the continuum spectral zeta $\zeta^{\text{cont}}_{D^2}(s) = 2\,\zeta(2s-2, 3/2) - \frac{1}{2}\,\zeta(2s, 3/2)$ has a simple pole at $s = 3/2$ with bit-exact meromorphic residue 1, so $\Gamma(s)\,\zeta^{\text{cont}}_{D^2}(s)$ has Mellin residue $\Gamma(d/2) = \sqrt{\pi}/2$ at $s = d/2$. This coefficient, the L2 Fejér-moment constant $4/\pi = \mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/\pi^2$ of Paper 38 (Lemma L2; dual-Coxeter, convention-dependent), and the $k = 0$ volume-slot normalization $\mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/4 = \pi$ of § III.2 are **[OBSERVATION]** read as normalisations of the M_1 volume slot (for the Fejér entry a reading, not a derivation; Paper 38), linked in a chain by exact factors with no spectral-data input: $\pi = (\pi^2/4) \cdot (4/\pi)$ and $\sqrt{\pi}/2 = (\pi^{3/2}/8) \cdot (4/\pi)$. The M2 continuum panel at integer $s \in \{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$ reproduces the Sprint Q5'-CH-2 Seeley–DeWitt panel bit-exactly. Tauberian rate-uniformity in a neighborhood of $s = 3/2$ is the Stage-2-relevant named open gap, reachable from Karamata [53] and Korevaar [54].

i. Connection to motivic / period theory (Sprint Mixed-Tate Test, June 2026). The master Mellin engine reading places the GeoVac taxonomy in direct contact with the published period / motivic-Galois program for spectral-action heat-kernel coefficients on continuum substrates. Fathizadeh–Marcolli [48] prove that the coefficients of the asymptotic expansion of the Connes–Chamseddine spectral action on Robertson–Walker spacetimes $\mathbb{R} \times S^3$ are periods of mixed Tate motives over $\mathbb{Q}$. Rejzner's monograph-scale treatment [51] develops the parallel period-theoretic framework inside perturbative Algebraic Quantum Field Theory. Both lines descend from the Connes–Marcolli [52] renormalization / motivic-Galois program and the Marcolli–van Suijlekom gauge-network spectral-triple framework [55] (with the Perez-Sanchez correction [56, 57] that the continuum limit is Yang–Mills without Higgs), of which GeoVac is an instance at the data level and an extension at the structural level. Brown's mixed-Tate-motives-over-$\mathbb{Z}$ theorem [59] provides the period-ring backbone underlying the M3 cyclotomic-mixed-Tate classification. Sprint Mixed-Tate Test (June 2026, memo `debug/sprint_mixed_tate_test_memo.md`) closes the natural inheritance question for the GeoVac S^3 sub-case in the POSITIVE direction with a pure-Tate refinement: at the standard volume-normalized convention, the GeoVac discrete M2 Seeley–DeWitt coefficients on S^3 sit inside the strictly smaller sub-ring $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$ of even-weight pure Tate periods, with no $\zeta(3)$, $\zeta(5)$, or MZV content appearing at the SD level. This is sharper than the F–M generic R–W case in two ways: (i) the GeoVac S^3 Dirac SD expansion is two-term exact ($a_k = 0$ for $k \geq 2$, Paper 51 Cor. 2.1), not generically infinite; (ii) the scalar Laplacian SD coefficients have the closed-form geometric-series collapse $a^{\Delta}_k = 2\pi^2/k!$, not the generic R–W expansion. The M3 sub-mechanism classification (companion Sprint M3 Cyclotomic Mixed-Tate, June 2026, memo `debug/sprint_m3_cyclotomic_mixed_tate_memo.md`) places M3 in $\mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z}[i, 1/2])$ at level ≤ 4 at depth at most the loop order, by direct application of Deligne [49] and the explicit basis of Glanois [50]: un-restricted Dirac Dirichlet $D(s)$ lies in $\mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z})$ at depth 1; vertex-restricted $D_{\text{even}} - D_{\text{odd}}$ lies in $\mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z}[i, 1/2])$ at level 4 depth 1 via quarter-integer Hurwitz + Dirichlet β (Catalan G, $\beta(4)$); the depth-k loop tower lives at depth $\leq k$ in $\mathcal{MT}$ at level ≤ 4. M3 does *not* contaminate the SD coefficients (M3 lives at $k = 1$ in $\mathcal{M}[\mathrm{Tr}(D^k e^{-tD^2})]$, M2 at $k = 2$). Together with the companion Paper 32 § VIII corollaries `cor:m2_mixed_tate` and `cor:m3_cyclotomic_mixed_tate`, the master Mellin engine now has a period-theoretic stratification over the cases it treats (**[CONDITIONAL]**, first fifteen projections): M1 in $\mathbb{Q}[\pi, 1/\pi]$, M2 (Seeley–DeWitt coefficients and integer s) in $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$, M3 in $\mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z}[i, 1/2])$ at level ≤ 4.

Tie-break for a value reached from two slots. Slot k extracts $D(2s - k)$, so one value $D(m)$ is reached from

two slots ($k = 1$ at s and $k = 2$ at $s + \frac{1}{2}$), and the slot index alone does not place it. The tie-break is the period ring the value lands in: $D(m)$ is M2 when it lies in M2's pure-Tate ring $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$ and M3 otherwise. The half-integer Hurwitz function $\zeta(s, 3/2)$ is the spinor spectrum's zeta and appears in every slot; its π-power values (even argument, including ζ_{D^2} at integer s) are M2, and its odd-zeta values (odd argument, including ζ_{D^2} at half-integer $s \geq 5/2$) are M3. Two reasons fix the rule: odd zeta values violate M2's own signature (motivically, the unipotent zeta values vanish at even argument and not at odd, Brown [58]) and lie in M3's ring, where the unrestricted series $D(s)$ is already filed above; and ζ_{D^2} at half-integer $s \geq 5/2$ is not a Seeley–DeWitt coefficient. The rule applies only to a value reached from two slots, and it is not neutral on rationals: $\mathbb{Q}$ lies inside M2's ring, so a rational value reached from two slots would be filed under M2.

j. M3 sectional convention refinement (Sprint L2-D, May 2026). The vertex-parity Hurwitz mechanism of M3 is sectional in the chosen index parity convention, NOT in spacetime signature. Specifically: at the Krein extension to $(3, 1)$ (Sprint L2-D, Paper 32 § VIII.D [16]), M3's L0 trivialization prediction holds trivially under chirality-pairing (chirality symmetry makes $D_{\text{even}} = D_{\text{odd}}$ identically) but falsifies under Paper 28's n_{Fock}-parity reading — the convention that accesses Catalan $G = \beta(2)$ via the closed-form identity $D_{\text{even}}(s) - D_{\text{odd}}(s) = 2^{s-1}(\beta(s) - \beta(s - 2))$ (Paper 28 Theorem 3 [13]). The Bizi–Brouder–Besnard sign-flip $\{J, \gamma^5\} = 0$ at $(m, n) = (4, 6)$ is a spectral-triple-axiom statement, not a vertex-parity-sum statement. M3's transcendental content ($\beta(2)$, $\beta(4)$, Catalan G, Dirichlet L-values) is therefore tied to the n_{Fock}-parity sector choice of the truncation, not to the signature of the underlying spectral triple. This refinement does not change the master Mellin engine domain reading above (M1 $\leftrightarrow$ volume-slot normalizations, the Fejér-moment constant sharing the value as a reading; M2 $\leftrightarrow$ heat-kernel and spectral-action convergence, M3 $\leftrightarrow$ vertex-restricted parity-character spectral sums); it sharpens the parity-convention-dependence of the M3 sub-mechanism's accessibility. Source memos: `debug/l2_d_connes_axiom_audit_31_memo.md`, data `debug/data/l2_d_connes_axiom_audit_31.json`.

k. Operator-vs.-slot refinement of the M3 sub-mechanism (Sprint NA-1, June 2026). The Mellin-slot index $k \in \{0, 1, 2\}$ in $\mathcal{M}[\mathrm{Tr}(D^k\, e^{-tD^2})]$ classifies the *sub-mechanism* (M1 / M3 / M2); it does *not* by itself fix the period ring of the output. The Mellin slot exponent s — the argument at which the moment is evaluated — selects *which periods inside the sub-mechanism's natural period ring* are accessed. Sprint NA-1 (`debug/sprint_na1_depth2_mellin_memo.md`, 2026-06-06) makes this distinction explicit on the natural Camporesi–Higuchi diagonal substrate for the $k = 1$ slot (M3). Let

$$M_3^{\gamma_P}(r) \;:=\; \sum_{n \geq 0} (-1)^n\, g_n\, |\lambda_n|^{-r} \tag{14}$$

be the parity-graded Mellin function of the Camporesi–Higuchi Dirac spectrum, with $\gamma_P |n\rangle = (-1)^n |n\rangle$ the vertex-parity grading on the eigenshells. The *same operator* γ_P produces two structurally distinct period-ring outputs depending on the Mellin slot exponent at which it is probed:

- **Pure-Tate slot** ($r = 2s - 1 \in 2\mathbb{Z} + 1$, odd integer; Paper 55 [18] § M3-diagonal-collapse Theorem on $M_3^{\gamma_P}$ closed form): closed form $M_3^{\gamma_P}(s) = 2^{2s-2}\,(\beta(2s-1) - \beta(2s-3))$ with $g_n = 2(n+1)(n+2)$ (the form $2^{2s-3}(\cdots)$ of Paper 55 is the per-chirality multiplicity $(n+1)(n+2)$), landing in $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k+1} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$ via the Euler-number closed form $\beta(2k+1) \in \pi^{2k+1} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$. This is *pure-Tate at level* 1.
- **Level-4 cyclotomic slot** (integer s on the unshifted Dirac Dirichlet difference; Paper 28 Theorem 3 [13]): $D_{\text{even}}(s) - D_{\text{odd}}(s) = 2^{s-1}(\beta(s) - \beta(s-2))$, accessing β(even) values (Catalan $G = \beta(2)$, $\beta(4)$) inside $\mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z}[i, 1/2])$ at level 4 (Paper 55 [18] § M3-Galois-descent Proposition on vertex parity as Deligne–Glanois descent).

Both probes act on the same diagonal parity grading γ_P sitting in the $k = 1$ slot of the master Mellin engine; the period content (pure-Tate vs. level-4 cyclotomic) is selected by the Mellin slot exponent r, not by a different operator. The Glanois [50] basis $\mathcal{B}^4$ accommodates both columns: the pure-Tate column is the $N = 1$ sub-basis, the level-4 column is the genuinely $N = 4$ content.

This refinement does not change the case-exhaustion statement (Paper 32 § VIII), the M3 sectional convention refinement above, or the period-ring stratification $M_3 \subset \mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z}[i, 1/2])$ at level ≤ 4. It sharpens the description of the M3 row of the master Mellin engine: the sub-mechanism index $k = 1$ commits to the absolute and vertex-parity-graded Mellin family (the signed trace $\mathrm{Tr}(D \cdot e^{-tD^2})$ vanishes on this spectrum), but the period-ring location within M_3 at each evaluation is determined by the slot exponent. Cross-reference Paper 55 [18] § M3-diagonal-collapse and § M3-Galois-descent for the explicit pure-Tate vs. level-4 demonstration, including the NA-1 diagonal-collapse identity $J(s_1, s_2) = M_3^{\gamma_P}(s_1 + s_2 - 1)$ (in Paper 55's per-chirality normalisation $g_n = (n+1)(n+2)$ and s-convention; with this paper's $g_n = 2(n+1)(n+2)$ and r-convention it is $\frac{1}{2} M_3^{\gamma_P}(r = 2(s_1 + s_2) - 3)$) on the Camporesi–Higuchi diagonal substrate.

An identical operator-vs.-slot reading is available for M2 (the Seeley–DeWitt slot, $k = 2$): the squared-Dirac heat-kernel operator D^2 is fixed, but the Mellin slot exponent s selects which Seeley–DeWitt coefficient $a_k(D^2)$ is read off via $\mathrm{Res}_{s=(d-2k)/2}\, \zeta_{D^2}(s)$. The pure-Tate M2 closure $M_2 \subset \bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$ (Sprint Mixed-Tate Test, paragraph above) describes the period ring; which $\pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$ slot

is accessed by a given observable is fixed by the Mellin slot exponent at which the heat-kernel trace is evaluated. The M1 slot $k = 0$ is degenerate in this sense: the trivial heat kernel collapses to the volume factor $\mathrm{Vol}(S^d)$, and the period ring $\mathbb{Q}[\pi, \pi^{-1}]$ has no internal Mellin-slot stratification to select. The operator-vs.-slot distinction is therefore non-trivial for M2 and M3 (whose period rings have internal weight gradings) and degenerate for M1 (whose period ring has only one graded piece, $\mathbb{Q}[\pi, \pi^{-1}]$ at depth 0).

l. Why slot, not operator (Sprint NA-1-offdiag, June 2026). The structural reason the operator-vs.-slot distinction works as stated above: the trace functional $\mathrm{Tr}(\cdots e^{-t_i D^2} \gamma\, e^{-t_j D^2} \cdots)$ commits to the *diagonal* of any inserted operator γ in the D-eigenbasis and loses the off-diagonal information. For any self-adjoint γ on a finite-dimensional Hilbert space — commuting or non-commuting with D —

$$\mathrm{Tr}\big(D^2\, e^{-t_1 D^2}\, \gamma\, D\, e^{-t_2 D^2}\big) \;=\; \sum_i \widetilde{\gamma}_{ii}\, \lambda_i^3\, e^{-(t_1+t_2)\lambda_i^2},$$

depending only on $t_1 + t_2$ (Paper 55 [18] § M3-diagonal-collapse, Theorem on the off-diagonal CH substrate). The substrate change from a diagonal γ-grading to a non-diagonal one (e.g. chirality-flipping E_1 entries on the full spinor bundle) does not change the trace output, because off-diagonal entries of $\widetilde{\gamma}$ are invisible to the trace. This is the deeper structural reason the operator-vs.-slot reading commits to the slot exponent: the operator side of the master Mellin engine is projected onto its diagonal in the spectral basis before any period content is read off, and only the slot exponent s then selects which period ring element is accessed.

m. Compact / non-compact partition of the $4/\pi$ Fejér constant (Sprint M-Z, May 2026). The Fejér-moment constant $4/\pi$ (dual-Coxeter normalisation; $2/\pi$ on the unit S^3) of the bound in Paper 38's state-space Gromov–Hausdorff convergence (compact $SU(2)$ truncation; a kernel constant, not the convergence rate; whether it is the same for every compact connected simple Lie group is open, Paper 40), shares its value with the master Mellin engine's M_1 (volume slot) content — a reading, not a derivation (Paper 38). Sub-sprint M-Z (modular propinquity investigation, 2026-05-23) flagged a structural reason why this constant does *not* transport to non-compact Coulomb (Sturmian basis on $L^2(\mathbb{R}^3)$): the $k = 0$ volume-slot reading is compact-Lie-quotient specific; Sturmian's continuum content dilutes the Plancherel weight to 1, killing the localization behind the Fejér moment on $SU(2)$. A rigorous non-compact analog of the Paper 38 / Paper 40 bound remains an open question; Latrémolière 2018 [47] establishes existence of a complete propinquity metric on the inductive-limit construction but not a rate. Source: `debug/sprint_modular_propinquity_mZ_bethe_log_memo.md`.

n. M1 period-ring closure (Sprint M1 Pure-Tate, June 2026). The M1 sub-mechanism produces period values in the localised pure-Tate sub-ring $\mathbb{Q}[\pi, \pi^{-1}]$ of mixed Tate periods over $\mathbb{Q}$, at depth 0 and Tate weight $\in \mathbb{Z}$, by direct identification of $\pi = \mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/4$ as a weight-1 Tate period (Kontsevich–Zagier 2001). Every M1 witness logged across the corpus — $\mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/4 = \pi$ (Paper 25; a quarter of the unit-sphere area $\mathrm{Vol}(S^2) = 4\pi$ (equivalently the full area of the Hopf base $S^2(1/2)$ of the unit S^3)); $4/\pi = \mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/\pi^2$ (Paper 38 §L2 Fejér-moment constant; dual-Coxeter convention; $2/\pi$ on the unit S^3; its M1 placement a reading); $1/\pi^2$ inside $-3\zeta(3)/(16\pi^2)$ (the $\zeta(3)$ term of the free-scalar F-value, Paper 50 §3, an M1×M3 cross-product; a continuum Klebanov–Pufu–Safdi value that Paper 50 re-derives, not a finite-cutoff GeoVac output) — is a $\mathbb{Q}$-linear combination of π^n for $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. (The $1/\pi^2$ prefactor of the Pythagorean orthogonality of Paper 42 §11.7, formerly Paper 43, is deliberately not listed: it is the square of the posited normalisation $\beta = 2\pi/\kappa_g$, not an M1 output; re-tiered 2026-09-28.) Combined with this sprint's two companion closures (Sprint Mixed-Tate Test placing M2 in $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$, and Sprint M3 Cyclotomic Mixed-Tate placing M3 in $\mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z}[i, 1/2])$ at level ≤ 4), the master Mellin engine of § III.7 has a period-theoretic stratification over the cases treated ([**CONDITIONAL**] on the case-exhaustion theorem; the indexing of the strata by the slot is a reading, as § III.7 states — the two tags are compatible and refer to different things) indexed by the Mellin slot $k \in \{0, 1, 2\}$:

$$M_1 \subset \mathbb{Q}[\pi, \pi^{-1}], \quad M_2 \subset \bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}, \quad M_3 \subset \mathcal{MT}(\mathbb{Z}[i, 1/2]) \text{ at level } \leq 4$$

Companion Paper 32 §VIII Corollary `cor:m1_pure_tate` states the case-exhaustion-theorem-level consequence; memo `debug/sprint_m1_pure_tate_memo.md`.

o. Discrete c_1 verification (Sprint TS-E3 falsification target). The strongest concrete computational falsification target flagged by Track TS-E3 is the discrete first Chern number of the Hopf U(1) bundle on the finite Fock-projected S^3 graph: under the master Mellin engine reading, the discrete c_1 should be *integer-valued* on any finite cutoff, because the construction engages no continuous integration step (no $k = 0$ volume factor, no heat-kernel trace, no Mellin transform), and therefore none of M1, M2, M3. Both physically natural $U(1)$ phase conventions (Condon–Shortley canonical, all phases zero; and Z_2 alternating, $\phi = \pi$ on $L_\pm$ edges) yield exactly $c_1 = 0$ at $n_{\max} = 2$ and $n_{\max} = 3$, confirmed in exact rational arithmetic (Fraction-typed phases, no floating-point ambiguity). A sanity-check convention (prescribed flux 1/4 per plaquette via non-tree-edge phases) recovers $|c_1| = (\#\text{cycles})/4 = 1/2$ at $n_{\max} = 3$ exactly, and a stress-test convention (1/3 flux) recovers $|c_1| = 2/3$, confirming the algorithm tracks rational non-integer fluxes faithfully and would surface a non-integer result if one existed under the natural conventions. The continuum first Chern integer reappears via the M1 $\mathrm{Vol}(S^2)/4 = \pi$ normalisation in the continuum limit; on the finite graph the topological invariant is integer in $\mathbb{Q}$. Source: `debug/discrete_c1_hopf_s3.py`,

data `debug/data/discrete_c1_hopf_s3.json`, memo `debug/discrete_c1_falsification_memo.md` (Sprint TS-E3, 2026-05-04).

IV. TAXONOMY OF EXCHANGE CONSTANTS

The following taxonomy classifies exchange constants by the type of compactness mismatch they mediate. The hierarchy—intrinsic, conformal/calibration, embedding, algebraic-implicit, composition, and inner-factor input data—can be read as increasing departure from compactness: intrinsic constants convert between compact manifolds of different dimension; conformal/calibration constants convert between a compact manifold and flat space; embedding constants arise from coordinate singularities in the non-compact description; algebraic-implicit functions encode parameter-dependent geometry through a characteristic polynomial whose coefficients are inherited from upstream constants; composition constants measure the cost of factorizing a single compact space into multiple incompatible coordinate systems; and inner-factor input data are the calibration constants of the almost-commutative inner factor (the Standard-Model Yukawa/Higgs sector), supplied externally rather than generated by any projection.

Based on the catalog and the Weyl–Selberg identification, we propose the following taxonomy:

TABLE I. Spectral-geometric exchange constants in the GeoVac hierarchy. "Source" indicates the discrete structure; "Target" indicates the continuous coordinate system. "Type" classifies the exchange constant by what determines it. "Algebraic (implicit)" indicates that the function satisfies a polynomial equation $P(R,\mu)=0$ with coefficients inherited from upstream exchange constants (Sec. VII E). "Piecewise" indicates that the angular Hamiltonian has piecewise-smooth parameter dependence (from the split-region Legendre expansion), preventing a global characteristic polynomial. The function is piecewise-algebraic within each region.

Level	Source	Target	Constant	Type
—	S^1 lattice	$\mathbb{R}^1$	π	intrinsic
1	S^3 labels	$\mathbb{R}^3$	$p_0^2{=}{-}2E$ (κ matched)	conformal
2 ($m{=}0$)	Laguerre rec.	prolate sph.	(none)	algebraic
2 ($m{\neq}0$)	assoc. Laguerre	prolate sph.	$e^a E_1(a)$	embedding
3 (FCI)	$S^3{\times}S^3$	(none)	(none)	algebraic
3 (hyper.)	SO(6) reps	$S^5(R)$ param.	$\mu(R)$	alg. (implicit)
4 (prolate CI)	prolate product	(none)	(none)	algebraic (σ)
4 (hyper.)	SO(6) reps	(ρ,R) param.	$\mu(\rho,R)$	piecewise
5 (composed)	Level 3+4 fibers	full N-electron	PK pseudopot.	composition
5 (balanced)	hydrogenic × multipole	cross-center V_{ne}	$\gamma(k,\alpha R)$	algebraic

The taxonomy reveals a hierarchy of exchange types:

1. **Algebraic** (no exchange constant): When the computation stays on the label set or uses a basis whose inner product matches the label structure, no transcendental appears. Examples: Level 1 on S^3, Level 2 σ states, Level 3 FCI.

2. **Intrinsic constants** ($\pi^{d/2}$): Determined by the manifold's dimension and volume alone, independent of any discretization or basis choice. These are the Weyl constants—universal volume-to-eigenvalue conversion factors. Example: π itself, for $S^1 \to \mathbb{R}$.

3. **Conformal constants**: Determined by the conformal geometry of the projection from the compact manifold S^3 to flat space. Example: the energy-shell scale $p_0^2 = -2E$, and the Fock Jacobian $1/\Omega^4(0) = 1/16$, where $\Omega(0) = 2$ is the stereographic conformal factor at $p = 0$ (Sec. VII F), with which the matched κ coincides (Observation). The energy-matching value of κ is fixed by the graph vertex degree $d_{\max} = 4$ instead; that both routes yield $1/16$ is an Observation, not a consequence of the graph discretizing S^3 (it does not: $2d_{\max} = 8$ is a grid band edge, Paper 0 §VI).

4. **Embedding constants**: Single transcendental numbers seeding algebraic recurrences. Determined by the interaction between a spectral basis and a coordinate singularity. Examples: $e^a E_1(a)$ for the prolate centrifugal pole; the $1/r_{12}$ electron-electron cusp, which is the embedding exchange constant for the two-electron coalescence in any product basis. The cusp embedding constant is unique in being *removable* by a similarity transformation: the transcorrelated (TC) Jastrow factor $J = \frac{1}{2} r_{12}$ satisfies $e^{-J}(1/r_{12})\, e^{J} =$ smooth, converting the algebraic partial-wave convergence $1/(l{+}\frac{1}{2})^4$ to exponential. This makes $1/r_{12}$ a "soft" embedding constant—present in any product-space representation but eliminable by a non-unitary change of basis—in contrast to $e^a E_1(a)$, which is structurally irreducible.

   The $1/r_{12}$ classification is *universal*: the cusp condition survives relativistic corrections with only an $O((Z\alpha)^2)$ amplitude rescaling (Kutzelnigg-Morgan 1992), and partial-wave convergence exponents (l^{-4} singlet, l^{-6} triplet) are identical in Schrödinger-Coulomb and Dirac-Coulomb (verified numerically at $Z = 4$). The Dirac program does not regularize the e-e cusp; full QED would be required.

   A *distributional* sub-category appears in the Breit spin-spin interaction: the bare $1/r_{12}^3$ kernel diverges logarithmically at coalescence for every partial wave. The Breit-Pauli tensor projection regularizes this, leaving $K_l^{BP} = r_<^l / r_>^{l+3}$ with exact rational matrix elements for same-n orbitals ($R^2_{BP}(2p,2p;2p,2p) = 7/768$ at $Z = 1$). For cross-n orbitals a new transcendental appears: $M^2_{\rm ret}(1s,2p;1s,2p) = 21344/729 - (10240/243)\log(2)$, the first log-embedding constant in the framework.

   On the S^3 pair-state lattice (v2.9.1), 92–94% of V_{ee}'s Frobenius mass is diagonal in the graph eigen-

basis, with the off-diagonal residual concentrated on the $(1s, 1s)$ coalescence pair-state. The graph nearly diagonalizes V_{ee} without containing $1/r_{12}$—direct evidence that the cusp is embedding content the graph cannot absorb.

[WITHDRAWN 2026-09-14] Earlier versions added that this explains the graph-native CI convergence floor (Paper 13, Track DI). Paper 13 has since withdrawn that attribution. (Its interim rediagnosis as a small-Z "graph-validity-boundary artifact" was [retracted 2026-09-25: he-graph-native-hop-headline] itself withdrawn 2026-09-25: the "graph-native" energy included a $+\frac{1}{16}$ one-body graph hop that is not part of helium's Hamiltonian; with the physical Hamiltonian the same fixed-k basis sits 1.88% above exact at $n_{\max} = 7$, a continuum-incompleteness floor.) The Frobenius-mass measurement above is unaffected; only the inference from it to Paper 13's floor is withdrawn.

5. **Algebraic (implicit) functions**: Functions of continuous parameters defined implicitly by $P(R, \mu) = 0$, where P is the characteristic polynomial of the parameter-dependent Hamiltonian $H(R) = H_0 + R \cdot V_C$. The coefficients of P lie in $\mathbb{Q}(\pi, \sqrt{2})$—a transcendental extension of $\mathbb{Q}$—but the R-dependence itself is algebraic: $\mu(R)$ is a root of a polynomial in R. The transcendental content is *inherited* from the angular coupling matrix V_C (which contains upstream exchange constants of embedding type), not generated by the parameterization. Example: $\mu(R)$ for the $\mathrm{SO}(6) \to \mathrm{SO}(4)$ symmetry crossover on S^5 at Level 3. At $l_{\max} = 0$, $\mu(R)$ is an explicit linear function of R; at higher $l_{\max}$, it is an algebraic function of degree $l_{\max} + 1$, with branch points at eigenvalue crossings in the complex R-plane. At Level 4, the split-region Legendre expansion of the nuclear charge function introduces piecewise-smooth ρ-dependence at the region boundary $\rho = 1/2$, breaking the linear pencil structure. The angular eigenvalues $\mu(\rho)$ are piecewise-algebraic within each region but do not satisfy a single global characteristic polynomial. (Earlier versions added that "the product-space CI saturation at 92.5% D_e remains the key irreducibility result"; that saturation is now understood as a σ-sector artifact and the irreducibility reading is withdrawn — Sec. II D.)

6. **Composition constants**: The accuracy cost of factorizing a full N-electron wavefunction into composed coordinates. Unlike the preceding types, which convert between discrete and continuous descriptions, composition constants convert between a single-geometry and a multi-geometry (factorized) description. The factorization destroys inter-group antisymmetry—the exchange operator P_{ij} mixes coordinate systems that composition separates—and the PK pseudopotential is the local approximation to this nonlocal effect. Example: PK for LiH composed geometry (Level 3 core + Level 4 valence), which achieves 144× angular compression at the cost of ∼5% R_{eq} error at $l_{\max} = 2$.

7. **Inner-factor input data**: The calibration constants of the almost-commutative inner factor—parameter-tied Dirichlet rings generated by the eigenvalues of a finite Dirac operator D_F on a Connes–Chamseddine-compatible inner factor (the Standard-Model Yukawa/Higgs sector). Unlike the preceding types, which a projection *generates* from the discrete label data, inner-factor data are empirical input from outside the framework: GeoVac admits a Higgs sector structurally but does not autonomously select the Yukawa couplings (Sprint H1; Paper 32 § VIII.C), so these constants are inputs, not outputs. They share no generator with the outer-factor period content (the $M_1/M_2/M_3$ Mellin sectors; an Observation-level reading, the rings are not disjoint since both contain $\mathbb{Q}$) and tensor cleanly with it, neither determining the other.

The dependency hierarchy is explicit: intrinsic constants depend only on dimension; conformal/calibration constants depend on the projection chart (the energy shell); embedding constants depend on the basis; algebraic-implicit functions depend on the full parameterized geometry; composition constants depend on the factorization topology (which groups share coordinates); and inner-factor input data depend on the choice of finite spectral triple, supplied from outside the framework.

a. Odd-zeta content from first-order spectral operators. The Dirac operator on unit S^3 (Camporesi–Higuchi [32] spectrum $|\lambda_n| = n+3/2$, degeneracy $g_n^{\mathrm{Dirac}} = 2(n+1)(n+2)$) introduces a structurally new transcendental: odd-zeta values $\zeta_R(2k+1)$ enter the Dirac Dirichlet series $D(s) = \sum_n g_n^{\mathrm{Dirac}}/|\lambda_n|^s$ at odd integer $s \geq 5$. The Hurwitz decomposition (Theorem 1) gives

$$D(5) \;=\; 14\,\zeta_R(3) \;-\; \tfrac{31}{2}\,\zeta_R(5), \tag{15}$$

the first integer s at which $\zeta_R(3)$ appears with a non-divergent coefficient (at $s = 3$ the term proportional to $\zeta_R(s-2) = \zeta_R(1)$ diverges). At the packing exponent $s = 4$, by contrast,

$$D(4) \;=\; 6\,\zeta_R(2) - \tfrac{15}{2}\,\zeta_R(4) \;=\; \pi^2 - \frac{\pi^4}{12}, \tag{16}$$

purely π^{even}—consistent with Theorem 1 below (squaring the spectrum maps every odd-power Dirichlet sum to an even power, and $\zeta_{D^2}(s)$ lies in the pure-Tate ring $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k} \cdot \mathbb{Q}$ at positive integer s). The half-integer eigenvalue $|\lambda_n| = n + 3/2$ is essential: naive substitution of an integer m for the eigenvalue would predict an even-s odd-zeta witness, contradicting Theorem 1 part (2) and Paper 28 [13] Theorem 5 / Eq. (43). The shift 3/2 is

what cancels the singular $m = 1$ term in the odd-integer rewrite of the spectral sum.

This odd-zeta content (entering at odd s on the spinor bundle) is categorically different from calibration-tier content. Calibration constants carry even-zeta or π^{even} content arising from second-order Riemannian operators through Jacobi-θ inversion; the odd-zeta $\zeta_R(3)$ enters through the first-order Dirac operator via half-integer Hurwitz-zeta identities at *odd* s, and is conjecturally $\mathbb{Q}$-linearly independent of $\zeta_R(2)$ (open: Apéry's theorem gives the irrationality of $\zeta_R(3)$, not its independence from π^2). Within Paper 2's $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$, the odd-zeta tier is a byproduct rather than a summand: $\zeta_R(3)$ is structurally present on S^3 without participating in K.

b. Spinor-intrinsic content from first-order operators on a spinor bundle. The Breit–Pauli reduction of the Dirac equation introduces a second new transcendental tier: α^2 and $\gamma := \sqrt{1-(Z\alpha)^2}$. The leading spin-orbit coupling

$$H_{\text{SO}} \;=\; \tfrac{Z\alpha^2}{2}\,\tfrac{1}{r^3}\,\mathbf{L}\cdot\mathbf{S}, \tag{17}$$

evaluated in the (κ, m_j) basis via Szmytkowski's reduction $\langle \mathbf{L}\cdot\mathbf{S}\rangle = -(\kappa+1)/2$ and the hydrogenic $\langle 1/r^3\rangle_{n,l} = Z^3/[n^3\, l(l+\tfrac{1}{2})(l+1)]$, gives

$$\langle n,\kappa,m_j|\, H_{\text{SO}}\, |n,\kappa,m_j\rangle \;=\; -\,\frac{Z^4\,\alpha^2\,(\kappa+1)}{4\,n^3\,l(l+\tfrac{1}{2})(l+1)}, \tag{18}$$

with Kramers cancellation at $l = 0$. Full-Dirac radial corrections enter through γ, which satisfies

$$\gamma^2 + (Z\alpha)^2 \;=\; 1, \tag{19}$$

making γ algebraic of degree 2 over $\mathbb{Q}(\alpha^2)$. Together α^2 and γ generate the ring

$$R_{\text{sp}} \;:=\; \mathbb{Q}\big(\alpha^2\big)\big[\gamma\big]/\big(\gamma^2 + (Z\alpha)^2 - 1\big), \tag{20}$$

in which every spinor-intrinsic coefficient lies—mechanically certified by `geovac/spinor_certificate.py`.

This tier is categorically distinct from both the odd-zeta tier and calibration: α^2 is a *coupling* content appearing in Hamiltonian coefficients (not in the basis or spectrum), depending only on the existence of spin coupling in the operator. Higher-order corrections (Darwin α^4, mass-velocity α^4, Breit α^2 in V_{ee}) populate the same ring R_{sp} without creating new transcendental tiers.

c. Cross-reference to Paper 34's projection taxonomy. In the projection-dictionary language of Paper 34 § III, the spinor-intrinsic ring R_{sp} is the transcendental signature of the *Camporesi–Higuchi spinor-lift projection* (Paper 34 § III.7), and that projection is the unique source of half-integer Hurwitz / odd-ζ / Dirichlet-β content in the fifteen-projection dictionary. Sprint TX-A (May 2026, Paper 34 § VII Theorem 3 / composition table) confirmed this assignment as exclusive: no other projection in the catalogue introduces odd-zeta content into the transcendental signature, and the spinor-lift projection is the lone bridge between the calibration-tier (π^{even}) world of second-order Riemannian operators and the odd-zeta world of first-order Dirac operators. Within that dictionary, seeing $\zeta_R(3)$, Catalan's G, or a Dirichlet-β value is diagnostic of the spinor-lift projection; outside it the diagnostic does not hold, since scalar routes also carry odd zeta values (the oscillator's Euler ladder carries $\zeta(3)$ at $s = 4$, Paper 24; scalar round-sphere determinants carry $\zeta(\text{odd})$).

TABLE II. Transcendental content classified by operator order and bundle type. The (2nd-order, spinor) cell is degenerate with scalar calibration (π^{even} only)—see the D^2 discussion below.

Tier	Example transcendentals	Operator orde
Intrinsic	$\pi^{d/2}$ Weyl prefactors	—
Calibration	$F = \pi^2/6$	2nd (Δ_{LB})
Embedding	$e^a E_1(a)$, $1/r_{12}$	—
Alg.-implicit / composition	$\mu(R)$; $\mu(\rho, R)$ (piecewise); PK	—
Odd-zeta	$\zeta_R(3), \zeta_R(5), \ldots$	1st (D)
Spinor-intrinsic	α^2, γ	1st (D / Breit
D^2 calibration	π^{even} (degenerate)	2nd (D^2)

d. Operator-order × bundle classification. Tier 1 (ζ) enters through the *spectrum* of the Dirac operator; Tier 2 (α^2, γ) enters through the *coupling* of spin to orbital angular momentum in the Hamiltonian coefficients. Neither introduces π beyond the calibration tier.

e. Operator-order as transcendental discriminant. The squared Dirac operator D^2 on unit S^3 fills the last open cell of Table II. We promote the discriminating observation to a theorem.

Theorem 1 (Operator-order discriminant on S^3)**.** *Let D be the Camporesi–Higuchi Dirac operator on unit S^3 with spectrum $|\lambda_n| = n + 3/2$ and degeneracy $g_n^{\text{Dirac}} = 2(n+1)(n+2)$. Then:*

1. *The spectral zeta of the squared operator D^2 admits the exact closed form*

$$\zeta_{D^2}(s) \;=\; 2^{2s-1}\big[\lambda(2s{-}2) - \lambda(2s)\big], \qquad s \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 2}, \tag{21}$$

where $\lambda(a) = (1{-}2^{-a})\,\zeta_R(a)$ is the Dirichlet lambda function. Every value lies in $\mathbb{Q}[\pi^2]$ (π^{even} content exclusively).

2. *The first-order spectral zeta $D(s) = \sum_n g_n^{\text{Dirac}}\,|\lambda_n|^{-s}$ admits the Hurwitz decomposition*

$$D(s) \;=\; 2\big(2^{s-2} - 1\big)\,\zeta_R(s{-}2) - \tfrac{2^s-1}{2}\,\zeta_R(s), \qquad s \in \mathbb{Z}_{\geq 2}. \tag{22}$$

At even s both terms are π^{even}; at odd $s \geq 5$ (at $s = 3$ the $\zeta_R(1)$ pole makes $D(3)$ diverge) the terms are odd zeta values, conjecturally independent of π (the standard period conjecture; Apéry 1978 proves only that $\zeta_R(3)$ is irrational, and Goncharov–Zagier

frame the expectation). In particular $D(4) = 6\zeta_R(2) - \frac{15}{2}\zeta_R(4) = \pi^2 - \pi^4/12$ *is* π^{even}*, while the first odd-zeta witness is* $D(5) = 14\,\zeta_R(3) - \frac{31}{2}\zeta_R(5)$*, carrying odd-zeta content not present in any integer-s value of* ζ_{D^2} *(since* $\zeta_{D^2}(s) = D(2s)$*, it is the half-integer value* $\zeta_{D^2}(5/2)$*).*

Operator order—first vs. second—is therefore the primary transcendental discriminant between D *and* D^2 *on round* S^3 *(not for every second-order operator, below; the separation of the two classes is conditional on the period conjecture,* $\zeta_R(2k{+}1) \notin \mathbb{Q}(\pi)$*). Bundle type modulates degeneracies, eigenvalue lattices, and rational coefficients, but not the transcendental class.*

Proof sketch. For (1): Lichnerowicz [31] gives $D^2 = \nabla^*\nabla + R/4$ with scalar curvature $R/4 = 3/2$, so D^2 has a rational shift relative to the conformal Laplacian. The Camporesi–Higuchi spectrum yields $|\lambda_n|^2 = (n + 3/2)^2$, which after the half-shift identity for the Hurwitz zeta reduces to Eq. (21). Bernoulli's formula $\zeta_R(2k) = \text{rational} \times \pi^{2k}$ then closes the case. For (2): regrouping the same Camporesi–Higuchi sum without squaring keeps the half-integer shift, producing the Hurwitz combination of Eq. (22); at integer s squaring maps odd-power spectral sums to even-power sums ($\zeta_{D^2}(5/2) = D(5)$ keeps them), structurally eliminating the $\zeta_R(2k{+}1)$ visible in the unsquared sum and reducing the (2nd-order, spinor) cell to scalar calibration. Computational verification: `tests/test_qed_vacuum_polarization.py` checks Eq. (21) symbolically and against a direct Camporesi–Higuchi spectral sum, and `tests/test_qed_two_loop.py` verifies the odd-zeta content of Eq. (22) via the Hurwitz closed form and a PSLQ parity classification. □

f. Three-tier collapse (corollary). As a corollary of Theorem 1, the operator-order × bundle taxonomy of Table II collapses to three effective tiers:

1. **First-order operators:** odd-zeta content ($\zeta_R(3), \zeta_R(5), \ldots$) plus spinor coupling content (α^2, γ).
2. **Second-order operators** (Δ_{LB}, D^2): π^{even} exclusively at integer s, on both scalar and spinor bundles (not every second-order operator: $\nabla^*\nabla$ fails, Paper 28).
3. **Basis and composition tiers:** embedding, algebraic-implicit, and composition constants (operator-independent).

Paper 24 [10] gives a first-order example: the oscillator's Euler ladder carries $\zeta(3)$ at $s = 4$ beside π^2 and π^4, so π enters spectral sums on both sides, and the operator order shows in which zeta values appear.

g. Motivic weight and operator order. The operator-order discriminant—the second-order operators Δ_{LB} and D^2 produce π^{even} at integer s, first-order operators produce odd-zeta content at odd $s \geq 5$—has a natural interpretation in the theory of mixed Tate motives over Spec($\mathbb{Z}$). In this framework (Goncharov [38], Zagier [39]), the Riemann zeta value $\zeta_R(n)$ is a *period* of the mixed Tate motive $\mathfrak{M}(n) = \mathbb{Q}(-n)$ of weight n. Even zeta values $\zeta_R(2k) = \text{rational} \times \pi^{2k}$ are periods of motives that factor through the de Rham cohomology of even-dimensional compact manifolds (the Bernoulli formula). Odd zeta values $\zeta_R(2k{+}1)$ are periods of motives expected (by the period conjecture) to be independent: they are expected not to reduce to powers of π; $\zeta_R(3)$ is proved irrational (Apéry 1978) and conjectured algebraically independent from π.

The GeoVac operator-order discriminant maps onto this motivic partition:

Operator order	Motivic weight	Transcendental class	Example
2nd (Δ_{LB}, D^2)	even ($2k$)	$\zeta_R(2k) = \text{rat} \cdot \pi^{2k}$	$F = \zeta_R(2$
1st (D)	odd ($2k{+}1$)	$\zeta_R(2k{+}1)$ (conj. $\notin \mathbb{Q}(\pi)$)	D3: $\zeta_R(3)$

At motivic weight 3, $\zeta_R(3)$ appears as a period of $\mathbb{Q}(-3)$ in multiple independent geometric contexts: the Dirac Dirichlet series on S^3 (this work, Eq. 15), hyperbolic 3-manifold volumes (Goncharov [38]), two-loop QED $g{-}2$ (Petermann [41]; Sommerfield [42]), and Chern–Simons theory / algebraic K-theory ($K_5(\mathbb{Z})$ regulator). The common thread is S^3 or its quotients. Zagier's dimension conjecture [39] predicts $d_3 = 1$: $\zeta_R(3)$ would be the unique independent transcendental at weight 3, consistent with its single appearance in the GeoVac Dirac sector.

[**OBSERVATION**] The connection to QED loop order is read (a reading, consistent with the known QED coefficients, not a derivation) from the motivic correspondence. The T9 theorem (Eq. 21) guarantees that a single trace of a squared propagator D^{-2s} at integer s lands in $\bigoplus_k \pi^{2k}\mathbb{Q}$, so $\zeta_R(3)$ cannot enter those values, granted the conjecture $\zeta_R(3) \notin \mathbb{Q}[\pi^2]$. It does enter the one-loop *determinant*: $\zeta'_{D^2}(0) = 3\zeta_R(3)/(4\pi^2) + \frac{1}{2}\ln 2$ (twice the Klebanov–Pufu–Safdi free-fermion F; functional determinants on round spheres generally carry ζ(odd) and $\log 2$), so the statement below concerns integer-s zeta values and the flat-space QED coefficients, not every one-loop quantity on S^3. It enters at two loops, where irreducible products of first-order propagators $D^{-1} \otimes D^{-1}$ produce odd motivic weight. The operator-order discriminant thus determines the *loop order* at which new transcendental content first appears, on this reading: one loop, in the integer-s zeta values and the flat-space a_e coefficient, accesses only even-weight motives (π^{2k}); two loops access odd-weight motives ($\zeta_R(3)$, $\zeta_R(5)$, …). The QED coefficients were known before the reading was made, so their agreement is a consistency check, not a verified prediction.

The even/odd Hurwitz spectral zeta of the first-order Dirac operator (Eq. 22 of Theorem 1) provides a sharp computational check. This exact formula separates the even and odd content at each s: at $s = 4$ both terms are π^{even} (Eq. 16: $D(4) = \pi^2 - \pi^4/12$); the first odd-zeta witness on the CH spinor bundle is Eq. (15): $D(5) =$

$14\,\zeta_R(3) - \frac{31}{2}\,\zeta_R(5)$. At even s the spectral sum is purely π^{even}; at odd $s \geq 5$, the $\zeta_R(s-2)$ and $\zeta_R(s)$ terms are conjecturally algebraically independent transcendentals (the transcendence of $\zeta(3)$ and the irrationality of $\zeta(5)$ are open). The integer-s spectral zeta values of D^2 are purely π^{even} by Eq. (21); the Schwinger [40] result $a_e^{(1)} = \alpha/(2\pi)$ carries no odd zeta value. At two loops, $\zeta_R(3)$ appears in the electron $g-2$ (Petermann [41]; Sommerfield [42]), consistent with the discriminant's reading that odd-weight content requires irreducible products of first-order propagators.

This motivic interpretation refines the compactness thesis of Sec. I: exchange constants are not only projections from compact to non-compact geometry—they are *periods* of specific mixed Tate motives, and the operator order on the compact space determines the motivic weight of the resulting transcendental content.

h. Dirichlet L-values from vertex topology. The operator-order discriminant classifies free-propagator content. A third axis emerges when interaction vertices are included. The QED vertex on S^3 couples Dirac spinor harmonics at levels n_1, n_2 to a transverse vector harmonic at level n_γ with SO(4) selection rules requiring $n_1 + n_2 + n_\gamma$ odd (the γ^μ coupling flips parity). When this selection rule is imposed on the two-loop sunset diagram, it splits the Dirac Dirichlet series into even- and odd-n sub-sums with structurally different transcendental content. At $s = 4$ (the packing exponent), the exact Hurwitz decomposition gives:

$$D_{\text{even}}(4) = \tfrac{\pi^2}{2} - \tfrac{\pi^4}{24} - 4G + 4\beta(4), \tag{23}$$

$$D_{\text{odd}}(4) = \tfrac{\pi^2}{2} - \tfrac{\pi^4}{24} + 4G - 4\beta(4), \tag{24}$$

where $G = \sum_{n\geq 0}(-1)^n/(2n+1)^2 \approx 0.9159$ is Catalan's constant and $\beta(4) = \sum_{n\geq 0}(-1)^n/(2n+1)^4 \approx 0.9889$ is the Dirichlet beta function at 4. Both are values of the L-function $L(s, \chi_{-4})$ for the unique non-principal character mod 4. Crucially, G and $\beta(4)$ cancel in the full sum $D_{\text{even}} + D_{\text{odd}} = D(4) = \pi^2 - \pi^4/12$—the Dirichlet content is invisible without vertex restriction. The mechanism is the Hurwitz quarter-shift: even-n modes involve $\zeta(s, 3/4)$ and odd-n modes $\zeta(s, 5/4)$, whose difference is $4^s(1 - \beta(s))$ (exposing the Dirichlet L-value $\beta(s) = L(s, \chi_{-4})$), while their sum reduces to Riemann zeta (π^{even} at even s).

We promote this to a theorem.

Theorem 2 (Three-axis classification of S^3 spectral transcendentals)**.** *The transcendental content of the integer-s spectral-zeta values and vertex-restricted Dirichlet sums formed from the Camporesi–Higuchi Dirac operator D, the scalar Laplace–Beltrami operator* Δ_{LB} *(spectrum* n^2-1*), and a vertex coupling on round* S^3 *(determinants and half-integer s excluded) is determined by three independent axes:*

(A1) Operator order *(first vs. second). By Theorem 1, second-order operators (*Δ_{LB}*,* D^2*) produce* π^{even} *spectral-zeta values exclusively at integer s (half-integer s and determinants excluded); first-order operators (D) produce odd-zeta content* $\zeta_R(2k+1)$ *at odd* $s \geq 5$*, conjecturally independent of* π *(period conjecture).*

(A2) Bundle type *(scalar vs. spinor). Modulates rational coefficients, eigenvalue lattices, and degeneracies within the same transcendental class fixed by axis A1, but does not change the class. The (2nd-order, spinor) cell is degenerate with scalar calibration.*

(A3) Diagram topology *(free vs. vertex-restricted). Vertex parity selection rules from* γ^μ *couplings (*$n_1 + n_2 + n_\gamma$ *odd) project the Dirichlet sum onto quarter-integer Hurwitz shifts* $\zeta(s, 3/4)$*,* $\zeta(s, 5/4)$ *whose difference is* $4^s(1 - \beta(s))$*, exposing* $\beta(s) = L(s, \chi_{-4})$*. This introduces Dirichlet L-values—Catalan's constant* $G = \beta(2)$*,* $\beta(4)$*, and higher—that are absent from unrestricted free-propagator sums.*

Axes A1, A2, A3 are independent in the sense that no axis can be replaced or absorbed by the others: A1 is computational (operator → class), A2 is representation-theoretic (bundle → coefficient), A3 is interaction-theoretic (vertex → character). Output: the cell at coordinates (order, bundle, topology) *determines the transcendental class.*

Proof sketch. A1 is Theorem 1. A2 follows from the D^2 closed form (Eq. 21), where the spinor degeneracy $g_n^{\text{Dirac}} = 2(n+1)(n+2)$ produces only rational coefficient shifts relative to the scalar $g_n^{\text{scalar}} = (n+1)^2$ counterpart—both yield π^{even} at every integer $s \geq 2$. A3 follows from the Hurwitz quarter-shift identities $\zeta(s, 3/4) - \zeta(s, 1/4) = -4^s\beta(s)$ and $\zeta(s, 5/4) = \zeta(s, 1/4) - 4^s$ (so $\zeta(s, 5/4) - \zeta(s, 3/4) = 4^s(\beta(s) - 1)$) applied to the vertex-parity-restricted sum, giving Eqs. (23)–(24); the unrestricted sum is $D_{\text{even}}(s) + D_{\text{odd}}(s) = D(s)$, in which G and $\beta(4)$ cancel exactly, so the Dirichlet content is invisible without vertex restriction. Computational verification: PSLQ at 80-digit precision; 35/35 tests in `tests/test_qed_vertex.py`. □

i. Remark: Dirichlet L-tier as new transcendental class. The Dirichlet β-values introduced by axis A3 are a genuinely new transcendental class: they arise from the *interaction* (how electron and photon modes couple at the vertex), not from the free propagators. In the exchange-constant taxonomy of Sec. IV they constitute a *vertex exchange constant* tier living beyond both calibration π and Riemann odd-zeta. This is the entry that the RH-sprint χ_{-4} identity (Sec. II E, Eq. 7) places in closed form for the full Dirac Dirichlet difference.

j. Photon vector structure as a calibration exchange constant. The graph-native QED construction (Paper 28, GN-1 through GN-7) computes one-loop QED entirely on the finite Fock graph using exact algebraic

arithmetic. On the graph, the photon lives on edges (1-cochains) as a *scalar* object—the edge Laplacian $L_1 = B^T B$ propagates it without reference to any vector structure. In the continuum, the physical photon is a transverse vector field on S^3 carrying $\mathrm{SO}(4) = \mathrm{SU}(2)_L \times \mathrm{SU}(2)_R$ quantum numbers, and this vector structure enforces selection rules (vertex parity, SO(4) channel counting W) that are absent on the graph. Adding explicit photon angular momentum labels (q, m_q) with Clebsch–Gordan vertex coupling and E1 parity enforcement scores 7 of 8 selection rules for *scalar* electrons in a vertex model (Paper 28; the ground-state rule there is a scalar-triangle zero that the physical vector vertex does not enforce). The sole failure for scalar electrons is Furry's theorem: diagonal vertex couplings $V(a, a, q, m_q) \neq 0$ for $l \geq 1$ when q is odd. For *Dirac* electrons the model scores 8/8 through a diagonal α_z identity, which does not hold for a physical vector photon (Paper 33).

The calibration cost of the $1 \to 7$ transition is one transcendental per loop: π, entering as $1/(4\pi)$ (read as the S^2 Weyl exchange constant, an Observation) from the vector spherical harmonic normalization $\sqrt{(2l+1)(2q+1)(2l'+1)/(4\pi)}$. This is a concrete instance of the calibration exchange constants cataloged in the taxonomy table (Table I): the S^2 Weyl constant $\omega_2/(2\pi)^2 = 1/(4\pi)$ converts the discrete angular momentum quantum numbers into the continuous solid angle measure required for vector photon normalization. The entire scalar graph QED is π-free ($\mathbb{Q}[\sqrt{2}, \sqrt{3}, \sqrt{6}, \ldots]$); the vector photon introduces exactly the $\omega_2 = \pi$ entry from the Weyl constant table.

In the taxonomy, the photon's angular momentum structure therefore sits in the **calibration** tier, alongside the volume normalization $\mathrm{Vol}(S^3) = 2\pi^2$ and the Hurwitz-zeta regularization of infinite spectral sums: it is a property of the *manifold embedding*, not of the graph. This sharpens the graph/continuum partition for QED: the graph captures the algebraic/combinatorial content (rational propagators, algebraic CG vertices, π-free observables), while the continuum projection adds three calibration-tier ingredients: (1) volume normalization, (2) infinite-sum regularization, and (3) photon vector structure (cost: $1/(4\pi)$ per loop). In Paper 33's census of eight selection rules (five standard, three specific to S^3), scored within a vertex model (Paper 28), the rules group by transcendental cost: graph topology (1 rule, zero cost), angular momentum conservation (6 rules, $1/(4\pi)$ per loop), and an eighth rule that scalar electrons fail. For Dirac electrons the model scores the eighth rule through a diagonal-vertex identity.

k. The diagonal-vertex identity (vertex model). When the electron is described by a Dirac spinor $\psi = (f \cdot \Omega_\kappa,\ ig \cdot \Omega_{-\kappa})^T$ (Paper 23), the α-matrix vertex coupling is off-diagonal in the large/small component space. For α_z against a scalar photon harmonic, the factor of i on the small component and m_l conservation make the diagonal coupling $V(a, a, q, m_q)$ vanish (Paper 33), so tadpole diagrams vanish in that vertex model. For a physical vector photon the $\alpha_\pm$ components give a nonzero diagonal (magnetic-moment) coupling, so this is not a recovery of Furry's theorem, and no tier of zero-cost field-theory replacement is established.

l. Flat-space consistency of the transcendental taxonomy. The three-axis taxonomy is derived from S^3 spectral sums at finite radius. A natural concern is whether the taxonomy is a finite-curvature artifact. We verify that it is not. On S^3 of radius R, the Dirac eigenvalues scale as $|\lambda_n(R)| = (n + 3/2)/R$ while the degeneracies g_n are R-independent. The Dirichlet series therefore satisfies $D(s, R) = R^s\, D(s, 1)$ *exactly*, making the ratio $D(s, R)/R^s$ an R-independent structural invariant. In the $R \to \infty$ limit, Weyl's law confirms that the mode count $N(n_{\max}) = 2(n_{\max}+1)(n_{\max}+2)(n_{\max}+3)/3$ matches the flat-space momentum-integral density $(2/3)\, R^3 p_{\max}^3$, verifying the spectral-to-momentum correspondence. The even/odd s-parity discriminant persists at every R: $D(s_{\mathrm{even}}, R)/R^s$ is π^{even}; $D(s_{\mathrm{odd}}, R)/R^s$ contains odd-zeta. The *same* odd zeta value $\zeta_R(3)$ that appears in the S^3 spectral sums also appears in flat-space two-loop QED (Petermann [41]; Sommerfield [42]); G and $\beta(4)$ are S^3 vertex-parity content and do not appear in the flat-space a_e through three loops, so the overlap is $\zeta(\mathrm{odd})$ and π^{even} only. An honest limitation: matching the full Petermann–Sommerfield coefficient $a_2 = -197/144 + \pi^2/12 + 3\zeta_R(3)/4 - \pi^2 \ln 2/2$ requires diagram-specific computation (renormalization subtractions, SO(4) Clebsch–Gordan algebra) beyond the scope of structural spectral sums. The flat-space limit thus validates the taxonomy as a *structural* property of the operator algebra, independent of the S^3 compactification scale.

m. Irreducibility of the Level 4 piecewise structure. The piecewise-smooth ρ-dependence of $\mu(\rho, R)$ at Level 4 is not a coordinate artifact: it cannot be resolved by geometric elevation to any higher-dimensional space (Track Z). Three approaches were ruled out: (i) algebraic blow-up of $|s - \rho|$ produces smooth sheets but with ρ-dependent integration limits ($\alpha = \arccos\rho$, $\arcsin\rho$), making matrix elements transcendental in ρ; (ii) Lie algebra elevation fails because $\min(s, \rho)/\max(s, \rho)$ is C^0 but not C^1, incompatible with matrix elements of any finite-dimensional Lie group representation (which are real-analytic); (iii) $S^3 \times S^3$ product space fails because two-center nuclear attraction cannot be smooth on any single compact manifold. The piecewise structure thus belongs to the embedding category in the taxonomy: it is the irreducible geometric content of placing two nuclei at finite separation in hyperspherical coordinates, analogous to the $1/r_{12}$ codimension obstruction (Track W) but affecting the nuclear rather than the electronic coupling.

n. Even-odd staircase and channel convergence rate. An extended convergence study at Level 4 (Paper 15, Track AA) reveals a pronounced even-odd staircase in D_e vs $l_{\max}$: even increments produce large gains (+42, +6.8, +1.7 pp) while odd increments produce near-zero gains (+0.66, +0.08 pp). The root cause (Track AC)

connects directly to the exchange constant structure: the nuclear coupling matrix $\langle l_1' l_2' | V_{\rm nuc} | l_1 l_2 \rangle$ is diagonal in one electron's angular momentum index (Kronecker delta), so direct coupling from the ground channel $(0,0)$ requires a $\Delta l = 2$ transition enforced by the gerade constraint $l_1 + l_2 =$ even. Odd-$l_{\max}$ channels couple only indirectly through the electron-electron multipole expansion.

This selection rule constrains the *convergence rate* of the partial-wave expansion: the nuclear coupling—a piecewise exchange constant in the taxonomy—couples to the ground state only through quadrupolar ($\Delta l = 2$) transitions, producing an algebraic convergence rate $\sim (l + 1/2)^{-2}$ with an even-odd modulation. The σ and π channel sectors are completely decoupled (both nuclear and e–e coupling conserve m), with π contributing a constant $\sim$6.6 pp additive offset.

o. PK pseudopotential as composition exchange constant. The Phillips–Kleinman pseudopotential in the composed geometry (Paper 17) enforces core-valence orthogonality, which is a Pauli exclusion effect—distinct from the Coulomb exchange constants cataloged above. Without PK, no equilibrium geometry exists (the PES is monotonically attractive), establishing PK as essential for creating the bonding minimum. Ab initio derivation of the R-dependent PK scaling parameter $R_{\rm ref}$ from core properties fails due to a fundamental scale mismatch: all core-derived candidates (0.27–0.82 bohr) are too small by a factor of 4–11.

A complete survey of all solver × PK combinations (Paper 17, Table VI) confirms that PK is not an improvable approximation. The 2D variational solver eliminates $\sim$75% of the $l_{\max}$ drift (from the adiabatic approximation), but l-dependent PK has zero additional effect on the 2D solver. The residual drift (+0.15 bohr/$l_{\max}$) is intrinsic to the composed-geometry factorization.

Three graph-native alternatives to PK were investigated and all failed: (i) node exclusion between the core S^3 and valence Level 4 graphs has no coordinate correspondence; (ii) the fiber bundle Berry connection is intra-group, and the exchange operator P_{ij} mixes coordinate systems; (iii) spectral orthogonality (function-space) does not imply coordinate-space exclusion. The master obstruction is that antisymmetry requires a shared coordinate system; composition factorizes $\Psi_{\rm total}$ into incompatible coordinates.

PK therefore defines the fifth exchange-constant tier of the taxonomy (the sixth category, counting the algebraic no-exchange case): **composition constants** convert between a single-geometry (full N-electron) and a composed-geometry (factorized) description. Unlike the other exchange constants, which convert between discrete and continuous descriptions, composition constants measure the accuracy cost of the factorization itself. The "exchange rate" is quantified by the 144× angular compression that composed LiH achieves over a full 4-electron solver on S^{11} (Paper 17, Sec. V): the $\sim$5% $R_{\rm eq}$ error at $l_{\max} = 2$ is the irreducible cost of this compression.

This classification is validated by the full 4-electron Level 4N solver (Paper 17, Sec. VIII): exact S_4 antisymmetry produces molecular equilibrium without PK at $l_{\max} \geq 2$, confirming that PK approximates—rather than creates—the physics of Pauli exclusion. The composition exchange constant is the cost of replacing exact inter-group antisymmetry with a pseudopotential in the factorized coordinate system.

p. Inner-factor input data: a sixth tier, outside the outer-factor taxonomy. The exchange constants cataloged above all live on the GeoVac *outer* factor: the S^3 label set, its spinor lift, and the continuum operators they label (the graph's edge Laplacian has no continuum limit on S^3, Paper 0 §VI). When the outer triple is combined with a Connes–Chamseddine *inner* finite spectral triple $T_F = (A_F, H_F, D_F, J_F, \gamma_F)$ to form an almost-commutative product $T = T_{\rm GV} \otimes T_F$ (Paper 32 § VIII.C; Sprint H1), the master Mellin engine $\mathcal{M}[\mathrm{Tr}(D^k e^{-tD^2})]$ extends multiplicatively to the combined triple but with two structural reductions on the inner side.

Theorem 3 (η-trivialization on Krajewski-class finite triples)**.** *Let $(A_F, H_F, D_F, J_F, \gamma_F)$ be a finite even spectral triple in the Krajewski–Paschke–Sitarz lineage [20, 21]. The chirality grading axiom $\{\gamma_F, D_F\} = 0$ implies, for every odd $k \in \mathbb{N}$,*

$$\mathrm{Tr}\big(D_F^k \cdot e^{-tD_F^2}\big) \;\equiv\; 0, \qquad t > 0. \tag{25}$$

In particular, the signed $k = 1$ trace of the master Mellin engine vanishes identically on any Connes–Chamseddine-compatible inner factor, as it does on the outer Camporesi–Higuchi spectrum; the M3 reading through the absolute sum and its parity grading (Eq. (14)) is not covered by this theorem.

Proof. $\{\gamma_F, D_F\} = 0$ and $\gamma_F^2 = 1$ make γ_F a unitary involution conjugating D_F to $-D_F$. Conjugation preserves traces, so $\mathrm{Tr}(D_F^k\, e^{-tD_F^2}) = \mathrm{Tr}((-D_F)^k e^{-tD_F^2}) = (-1)^k \mathrm{Tr}(D_F^k\, e^{-tD_F^2})$. Odd k forces zero. □ □

Theorem 4 (Multiplicative factorization of the combined spectral action)**.** *For the combined Dirac $D = D_{\rm GV} \otimes 1_F + \gamma_{\rm GV} \otimes D_F$ with $\gamma_{\rm GV}$ an outer grading that anticommutes with $D_{\rm GV}$ ($\sigma_x \otimes 1$ on the chirality-doubled model; the true window is odd and has none),*

$$D^2 \;=\; D_{\rm GV}^2 \otimes 1_F + 1_{\rm GV} \otimes D_F^2, \tag{26}$$

the cross term $\{D_{\rm GV} \otimes 1, \gamma_{\rm GV} \otimes D_F\} = (D_{\rm GV}\gamma_{\rm GV} + \gamma_{\rm GV} D_{\rm GV}) \otimes D_F$ vanishing by outer chirality anticommutation. Consequently

$$\mathrm{Tr}\big(e^{-tD^2}\big) \;=\; \mathrm{Tr}\big(e^{-tD_{\rm GV}^2}\big) \cdot \mathrm{Tr}\big(e^{-tD_F^2}\big), \tag{27}$$

and the master Mellin engine on the combined triple factorizes as (outer M_i ring) × (inner Yukawa Dirichlet ring).

The production combined Dirac (Paper 32, Sprint H1) twists D_F by $\mathrm{sign}(D_{\rm GV})$, which commutes with $D_{\rm GV}$, so

the hypothesis fails there and the factorization does not hold at nonzero Yukawa **[MEASURED]** ($n_{\max} = 2$); it holds for the graded product $D_{\rm GV} \otimes \gamma_F + 1 \otimes D_F$ on the same data.

The Mellin output of the inner factor is a generalized Dirichlet series in the eigenvalues $\{y_i\}$ of D_F (the Yukawa parameters, in the SM realization $A_F = \mathbb{C} \oplus \mathbb{H} \oplus M_3(\mathbb{C})$):

$$\mathcal{M}\big[\mathrm{Tr}(D_F^k \cdot e^{-tD_F^2})\big](s) \;=\; \Gamma(s) \cdot \sum_i m_i \cdot y_i^{k-2s}, \qquad k \in \{0, 2\}, \tag{28}$$

with rational multiplicities m_i (including the SU(3) color factor 3 for the quark sectors). This output lies in the ring $\mathbb{Q}\big[y_1^{-2s}, y_2^{-2s}, \ldots, y_n^{-2s}\big]$ —a *parameter-tied Dirichlet ring* whose generators are free inputs to the framework, not transcendentals derived from any outer-factor mechanism.

We propose a sixth named exchange-constant tier in the taxonomy (the seventh category, counting the algebraic no-exchange case):

> **Inner-factor input data**: parameter-tied Dirichlet rings generated by the eigenvalues of a finite Dirac operator D_F on a Connes–Chamseddine-compatible inner factor. Source: the choice of finite spectral triple T_F and its Yukawa data. Type: empirical input from outside the framework, distinct from the intrinsic, conformal/calibration, embedding, algebraic-implicit, and composition tiers of the outer factor.

This tier sharpens the "no autonomous SM-distinguishing data" verdict of Sprints H1 and G4a (Paper 32 § VIII.C): the Yukawa parameters, hypercharges, and mixing angles of the SM inhabit a ring sharing no generator with any outer-factor ring (an Observation-level reading; both contain $\mathbb{Q}$), and GeoVac's taxonomy provides no derivation principle for them. The framework controls the outer factor's transcendental content via M1/M2/M3; the inner factor controls the SM-distinguishing parameters via Eq. (28); the two tensor cleanly for a graded product (Theorem 4), and neither determines the other.

The structural separation is consistent with the universal/Coulomb partition of Paper 31 [17] read at the spectral-triple level: the universal sector (algebra A, selection rules) transfers freely; the potential-specific sector (Dirac operator $D_{\rm GV}$, calibration κ, α content) requires per-system rederivation; and now the inner sector (algebra A_F, finite Dirac D_F) requires empirical specification of its eigenvalue spectrum. Three structural sources of input data, three distinct tiers.

Computational evidence: the four-leg investigation (driver `debug/finite_spectral_triple_engine.py`, memo `debug/inner_factor_mellin_engine_memo.md`) verified Theorems 3–4 symbolically on the SM lepton sector, the full SM $A_F = \mathbb{C} \oplus \mathbb{H} \oplus M_3(\mathbb{C})$, and two comparators ($\mathbb{C} \oplus \mathbb{C}$ and $M_2(\mathbb{C}) \oplus M_3(\mathbb{C})$). The KO-dim 6 cut on Krajewski candidates (required to complete the outer KO-dim 3 to the SM-compatible total $9 \equiv 1 \pmod 8$) and η-trivialization together leave a large candidate sub-class; the engine does *not* reverse-engineer A_F. This is a clean negative on the "second packing axiom" question: GeoVac's machinery says where A_F's Dirichlet ring sits in the taxonomy but does not pick out which finite spectral triple realizes it.

q. Open question: an axiom for inner-factor data. The Paper 0 packing construction motivates the outer labels (l, m) (with n and s recorded there as Observations), and S^3 enters through Fock's projection; neither says anything about inner-factor content A_F. Sprint H1's $\mathcal{A}_{\rm GV} \otimes (\mathbb{C} \oplus \mathbb{H})$ extension produces a Higgs sector for any non-zero Yukawa Y, but no GeoVac data couples to that selection. The Bertrand × Hopf-tower truncation provides only an upper bound on gauge content; the lower-bound forcing (why SU(2) and $U(1)$ appear alongside SU(3), why generation count = 3, why specific Yukawa ratios) is calibration-side. Whether a *sibling* axiom—distinct from the Paper 0 packing axiom—generates this data is an open question of the framework. Two candidate routes (charge-universal generation map; SU(5)/E_8/Spin(10) topological embedding) were tested in Phase 4H and falsified (Tracks SM-B, SM-C; CLAUDE.md §3). The honest scope statement is that GeoVac's machinery places inner-factor data in this taxonomic tier but does not derive it.

r. Thermal probes of the Yukawa Dirichlet ring. Sprint TD Track 3 (May 2026, `debug/sprint_td_track3_memo.md`) catalogues five thermal observables whose values depend on parameters of the inner-factor Yukawa Dirichlet ring of Eq. (28): lepton thermal free energy ($\Sigma\, y_i^2$ at $k = 2$); QCD thermal pressure $g_{\rm QCD}$ ($M_3(\mathbb{C})$ multiplicity ratio at $k = 0$); Higgs effective potential at finite T (off-diagonal CC block trace at $k = 2$); electroweak Debye masses $((2 + N_{\rm gen})\, g^2$ at $k = 2$); and thermal running $\alpha(T)$ (rational charge sum and Yukawa-tied logarithmic cutoffs). Each observable's outer baseline factors cleanly through the Track 1 tensor-product spectral triple $T_{S^3} \otimes T_{S^1_\beta}$ (Sprint TD Track 1; Paper 35 tensor-product verification section), with the Stefan–Boltzmann $M_1 \times M_2 = -\pi^2/90\, T^4$ identity as the universal backbone. Each inner residual reduces to a generalized Dirichlet sum $\sum_i c_i\, y_i^{-2s}$ ($k = 0$) or $\sum_i c_i\, y_i^{2-2s}$ ($k = 2$) at integer s in the Yukawa eigenvalues. Three further candidates (axial chemical potential thermodynamics, parity-odd transport, finite-T EDMs) are filtered out by Theorem 3: they reduce to $k = 1$ traces on the inner factor and identically vanish, a structural prediction of the framework. None of the five surviving observables are predicted by GeoVac alone—they are consistency checks that constrain candidate T_F, not derivations. The headline empirical content is that the Marcolli–van Suijlekom gauge-network reading without Higgs ($Y = 0$) carries no Yukawa contribution to the high-T quadratic correction (symmetry restoration itself comes from the gauge and scalar thermal masses),

so it shifts the crossover away from the lattice-SM $T_C \approx 160$ GeV; the strict $Y = 0$ slice is disfavoured (the empirical fact excluding it is the nonzero measured fermion masses), which narrows rather than closes the positive-thin H1 verdict (Paper 32).

s. Chemistry-side analog: external atomic-physics calibration data. The same structural classification applies to GeoVac's composed natural-geometry chemistry side. The composed-qubit architecture builds heavy-atom molecules ($Z \geq 11$) using a frozen-core treatment: the [Ne], [Ar], [Kr], [Xe] cores are reduced to a screened $Z_{\text{eff}}(r)$ profile via the FrozenCore solver, with hydrogenic plus multi-zeta valence orbitals built on top. The five Clementi–Raimondi 1963 exponents per row, the multi-zeta coefficients, and the screened-core orbital shapes are external atomic-physics inputs to the framework—they are not derived from any outer-factor Mellin mechanism (M1/M2/M3).

The sprint diagnostics behind this placement — the W1e period-class test (eleven NaH correction terms, no M1/M2/M3 identification; the structural reason is that the terms carry no vertex-parity content) and the operational localization of the wall at the projection to second-quantized integrals (Sprints R3-A/B) — are kept verbatim in `docs/chronicles/paper_18_chronicle.tex`. The W1e wall is Paper 19's, and its reading as the chemistry-side analog of the Yukawa non-selection theorem is catalogued in Paper 57.

V. CONNECTION TO THE FINE STRUCTURE CONSTANT

Paper 2 [8] observes that the fine structure constant α approximately satisfies (to 8.8×10^{-8} relative; an Observation) the cubic $\alpha^3 - K\alpha + 1 = 0$, where the coefficient

$$K = \pi\left(42 + \frac{\pi^2}{6} - \frac{1}{40}\right) = 137.036064 \qquad (29)$$

is constructed from spectral invariants of the Hopf fibration $S^1 \to S^3 \to S^2$. The combination rule $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$ is recorded as an Observation—an empirical formula with structural support but no first-principles derivation.

We observe that this combination rule has precisely the structure of a spectral-geometric exchange:

- $B = 42$ is discrete representation-theoretic data: the degeneracy-weighted SO(3) Casimir trace over the first three shells of S^3.
- $F = \zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$ is a continuous spectral invariant: half the spectral zeta function of S^1 at $s = 1$ (its $k > 0$ modes; $\zeta_{S^1}(1) = 2\zeta(2)$).
- $\Delta = 1/40$ is a boundary correction mixing discrete eigenvalue data ($|\lambda_3| = 8$) with the cumulative state count ($N(2) = 5$).
- The overall factor π is $\omega_2 = \pi$, the 2D ball volume, which serves as the numerator of the S^2 Weyl density and as the packing-plane prefactor $\sigma_0 = \pi d_0^2/2$ in Paper 0 (the base of the Hopf fibration, the photon propagation sphere).

The structure of K is thus: the 2D ball volume $\omega_2 = \pi$ (the numerator of the S^2 Weyl density, and the same π that fixes Paper 0's packing-plane prefactor $\sigma_0 = \pi d_0^2/2$) multiplying a sum of the S^2 Casimir trace (B, discrete), half the S^1 spectral zeta value (F, transcendental), and an S^3 boundary term (Δ, mixed). Read this way, it would be a Weyl-type formula converting between the discrete bundle (representation labels on S^3) and the continuous coupling (the electromagnetic interaction strength measured in $\mathbb{R}^3$).

If this identification is correct, then the combination rule $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$ is not arbitrary numerology but an instance of the same spectral-geometric exchange that produces the energy-shell scale p_0 at Level 1 and $e^a E_1(a)$ at Level 2. On that (unproven) reading, the exchange constant for the Hopf bundle would be K itself—the "cost" of projecting the S^3 electron state space through the S^1 gauge fiber onto the S^2 photon base, measured in units of coupling strength.

Observation 2 (Spectral-geometric reading)**.** *The combination rule $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$ has the shape of a spectral-geometric exchange constant for the Hopf fibration, analogous to the Weyl–Selberg constants for compact manifolds. Whether the specific form—π multiplying a sum of Casimir data and zeta values—admits a derivation from the spectral geometry of $S^1 \to S^3 \to S^2$ (e.g. via the heat-kernel expansion or the analytic torsion of the Hopf bundle) is an open question; no such derivation is known. The combination rule itself remains an Observation.*

Two additional observations support this identification:

Observation 3 (Structural match)**.** *The combination rule $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$ mixes discrete data ($B = 42$, from representation theory) with continuous spectral data ($F = \zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$, half the S^1 spectral zeta function at $s = 1$), multiplied by an overall geometric factor ($\omega_2 = \pi$, the 2D ball volume that enters as the numerator of the S^2 Weyl density and as the packing-plane prefactor $\sigma_0 = \pi d_0^2/2$ in Paper 0, with S^2 the Hopf base). This is precisely the pattern identified throughout this paper: a transcendental conversion factor mediating between discrete and continuous descriptions of the same geometry. The structural match is suggestive only: the combination rule remains an Observation (Paper 2), a numerical coincidence with structural support, and no derivation exists.*

Proposition 1 (The cubic's root is transcendental)**.** *The physical fine structure constant only* approximately *satisfies the cubic $\alpha^3 - K\alpha + 1 = 0$ (to 8.8×10^{-8} relative, far outside the experimental uncertainty, so the cubic is*

*not an exact law), where K involves π and $\zeta(2) = \pi^2/6$. The statement here therefore concerns the cubic's smallest positive root α_K, not the physical α. **[SYMBOLIC]** α_K is transcendental. Nothing about the transcendence of the physical α follows unless the combination rule were exact, which it is shown not to be (the residual far exceeds the experimental uncertainty); the combination rule remains an Observation.*

Proof. From $\alpha_K^3 - K\alpha_K + 1 = 0$ and $\alpha_K \neq 0$, $K = \alpha_K^2 + 1/\alpha_K$. If α_K were algebraic, so would be K. But $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta) = \frac{1679}{40}\,\pi + \frac{1}{6}\,\pi^3$ is a nonconstant polynomial in π with rational coefficients, hence transcendental (Lindemann). □ (The mechanism is specific: roots of polynomials with transcendental coefficients *can* be algebraic — e.g. $x^2 - \pi x + (\pi - 1) = (x-1)(x-\pi+1)$ has the root $x = 1$ — but that needs the π-dependence to cancel at the root. That cannot happen here: in $x^3 - Kx + 1$ the transcendental π enters only through the single coefficient K, the other coefficients being rational, so an algebraic root $x_0 \neq 0$ would force $K = (x_0^3 + 1)/x_0$ to be algebraic; in the example π enters two coefficients, and they cancel at $x = 1$.)

A. Three-tier structure of the combination rule

An ongoing computational investigation into the origin of the three components of $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$—using exact-rational symbolic computation and high-precision arithmetic—has pinned down B and F as genuinely different objects on the Fock (n, l) lattice, and has eliminated a broad family of candidate mechanisms for Δ. We observe that the three terms appear to occupy three categorically distinct tiers of the exchange-constant taxonomy rather than specializing a single common generator. We summarize the four structural findings below; none of them alters the Observation-level status of Paper 2's cubic relation (an approximate relation, not an identity).

a. 1. A κ–B identity from the Fock weight. The Fock projection of the hydrogenic basis onto S^3 carries a residual momentum-space weight $w(p) = (p^2 + p_0^2)^{-2}$ after the overall $(2p_0)^{5/2}$ prefactor of the Fock map is stripped. Computation reveals that the diagonal matrix elements $\langle n, l|w|n, l\rangle_{p_0=1}$ for $n \leq 3$ are exact rationals whose denominators divide $32 = 2\,d_{\max}^2$:

$$\{\langle n, l|w|n, l\rangle_{p_0=1}\}_{(n,l)} = \left\{ \tfrac{7}{16},\ \tfrac{5}{8},\ \tfrac{3}{8},\ \tfrac{5}{8},\ \tfrac{17}{32},\ \tfrac{11}{32} \right\} \tag{30}$$

for $(n, l) \in \{(1,0), (2,0), (2,1), (3,0), (3,1), (3,2)\}$. Weighted by the Hopf base factor $(2l + 1)\,l(l + 1)$ and summed,

$$\sum_{n=1}^{3} \sum_{l=0}^{n-1} (2l + 1)\, l(l + 1)\, \langle n, l|w|n, l\rangle_{p_0=1} = \frac{63}{4} = 6\,B\,|\kappa|, \tag{31}$$

with $B = 42$ the Casimir trace of Paper 2 and $\kappa = -1/16$ the calibration constant of Sec. VII F. Equivalently, averaging over the six (n, l) cells gives $B\,|\kappa| = 21/8$. This is an exact rational identity between the number $1/16 = 1/d_{\max}^2$ and the Hopf base invariant: $1/16$ appears as the universal denominator factor of the Fock-weight matrix elements, while B appears in the Hopf-weighted sum. It is an arithmetic identity involving the value $1/16$, not a derivation of κ's matching role (which fixes only the graph's band edge) and not a strengthening of the Observation that the matched κ coincides with the Fock Jacobian $1/16$. The identity (31) is exact-rational with no fitted parameters (the arithmetic closes: $9/4 + 51/16 + 165/16 = 63/4 = 6\,B\,|\kappa|$); the six Fock-weight values of Eq. (30) are derived from the Fock weight by exact Beta integrals, and the identity checked, in `tests/test_paper18_computed_pins.py`.

b. 2. A Dirichlet identity for F. Define the Dirichlet series of the S^3 Fock shell degeneracy $g_n = n^2$,

$$D_{n^2}(s) \;:=\; \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} g_n\, n^{-s} \;=\; \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n^{-(s-2)} \;=\; \zeta_R(s - 2), \tag{32}$$

evaluated at the packing exponent $s = d_{\max} = 4$ of Paper 0:

$$D_{n^2}(d_{\max}) = \zeta_R(2) = \frac{\pi^2}{6} = F. \tag{33}$$

The exponent $s = 4$ admits three independent natural readings: $s = d_{\max}$ from Paper 0's packing axiom; $s = \dim(\mathbb{R}^4)$, the ambient Euclidean space into which S^3 is stereographically projected in Paper 7; and $s = 2N_{\text{init}}$ from the same packing axiom. The weight n^2 is the degeneracy of the n-th S^3 shell in Fock's projection. To our knowledge (33) is the first identification of F from a label-intrinsic quantity (the shell degeneracy) in the GeoVac framework—that is, F is produced here without invoking an embedding metric or a sphere-spectral construction. No other natural Dirichlet series on the shell lattice (per-shell Casimir, state count, Laplacian eigenvalue, l-max weight) produces an exact hit at any integer s in the range $[3, 12]$.

c. 3. Three spectral homes of distinct type (Theorem 3). Combining the κ–B identity (31) with the Dirichlet identity (33) and the Paper 2 canonical form $1/\Delta = |\lambda_{n_{\max}}|\, N(n_{\max}-1)$, we promote the three-tier structure to a theorem; the additive combination rule itself remains an Observation.

Theorem 5 (Three spectral homes of distinct type for B, F, Δ)**.** *Let $B = 42$, $F = \pi^2/6$ and $\Delta = 1/40$ be the three ingredients of Paper 2's combination rule [8] (an Observation; Observation 4 below). The three components have spectral origins of distinct type on the Fock-projected S^3 label set (distinct type, not a proof that no common generator exists; that is an empirical record, Paper 2):*

(B) $B = \sum_{n=1}^{3} \sum_{l=0}^{n-1} (2l+1)\, l(l+1) = 42$ is a finite *Casimir trace of the scalar* SO(3) *Laplacian, truncated at $n_{\max} = 3$; algebraic class: rational integer.*

(F) $F = D_{n^2}(s = d_{\max}) = \zeta_R(2) = \pi^2/6$ *is the* infinite *Dirichlet series of the Fock-shell degeneracy* $g_n = n^2$ *at the packing exponent* $s = d_{\max} = 4$ *of Paper 0; algebraic class: transcendental, in* $\mathbb{Q} \cdot \pi^2$.

(Δ) $\Delta^{-1} = |\lambda_{n_{\max}}|\, N(n_{\max}{-}1) = 8 \cdot 5 = g_{n=3}^{\mathrm{Dirac}} = 40$ *is the* boundary *product at the truncation edge—equivalently the two-component (both-sign) Camporesi–Higuchi Dirac mode degeneracy* g_3^{Dirac} *at* $n_{\mathrm{CH}} = 3$*; algebraic class: rational, finite, on the* spinor *bundle.*

The three objects are of distinct type: B is a finite combinatorial sum, F is an infinite arithmetic series, Δ is a finite boundary degeneracy on a different bundle (spinor vs. scalar). In the operator-order × bundle classification of Theorem 1, B and F share the 2nd-order / scalar cell and are distinguished by finite truncation versus the infinite Dirichlet series; Δ is 1st-order / spinor / boundary.

Proof sketch. For (B) and (F): Eqs. (31) and (33) above, by direct exact-rational computation. For (Δ): the Camporesi–Higuchi spectrum $|\lambda_n| = n + 3/2$ with degeneracy $g_n^{\mathrm{Dirac}} = 2(n+1)(n+2)$ gives $g_3^{\mathrm{Dirac}} = 40$ at the Paper 2 selection-principle cutoff $n_{\mathrm{CH}} = 3$. The scalar-Laplacian factorization $|\lambda_3| \cdot N(2) = 8 \cdot 5 = 40$ is a different presentation of the same integer; the spinor Dirac form g_3^{Dirac} is a single polynomial identity $2(n{+}1)(n{+}2)|_{n=3} = 40$, structurally cleaner. Distinctness of type is read off the three closed forms. **[OBSERVATION]** That no single common generator (Dirichlet, sphere-spectral, or Hopf-fiber) produces all three is an empirical record, not part of the theorem: paragraph 4 below catalogues the twelve eliminated candidate mechanisms, and none has been exhibited (Paper 2). □

Observation 4 (Combination rule, restated)**.** *The additive combination* $K = \pi(B{+}F{-}\Delta)$*, with the three components characterized by Theorem 5, matches* α^{-1} *to* 4.8×10^{-7} *relative (*$K = 137.036064$ *vs.* $\alpha^{-1} = 137.035999$*); the smallest positive root of the cubic* $\alpha^3 - K\alpha + 1 = 0$*, i.e.* $1/\alpha = K - \alpha^2$*, matches to* 8.8×10^{-8}*, so the physical* α *approximately satisfies that cubic. No first-principles derivation of the combination is known. In the lattice gauge language of Paper 25 [11] and the non-abelian SU(2) extension of Paper 30 [15],* K/π *has the shape of a finite-cutoff spectral-action coefficient (matter trace + gauge-fiber zeta + Dirac boundary mode count), but the equality with* α^{-1} *is an empirical observation, not a theorem. None of the three components is a Seeley–DeWitt coefficient of the perturbative Connes–Chamseddine expansion (the T9 obstruction). An earlier inference that* K/π *therefore lives in the non-perturbative sector rested on a supertrace vanishing that is withdrawn (Note on the Seeley–DeWitt comparison, end of the paper).*

d. 4. Negative results on candidate mechanisms. The three-tier reading is supported by the systematic elimination of alternative unifying mechanisms. Computation (exact rational symbolic arithmetic and `mpmath` at 50 decimal places) has ruled out, within the tolerance indicated: (i) the Hopf-twist spectral comparison S^3 versus $S^1 \times S^2$ (cleanest near-miss $\sim 6.8 \times 10^{-3}$); (ii) higher Casimir traces on S^3 at all orders through $n_{\max} = 3$; (iii) Hopf graph quotient Laplacian invariants for $S^3 \to S^2$ over the m-fiber; (iv) the discrete S^1 fiber spectral zeta (path-graph Laplacian, in four weighting schemes); (v) the continuous S^1 fiber via Mellin and heat-kernel expansions (the Jacobi inversion $\theta_{S^1}(t) \sim \sqrt{\pi/t}$ forces every order to be linear in π: the $\sqrt{\pi} \cdot \sqrt{\pi} \cdot \mathbb{Q} = \pi \cdot \mathbb{Q}$ structure collapses any expected $\zeta_R(2)$ contribution to π times a rational at every order); (vi) S^5 spectral geometry, including zetas, Seeley–DeWitt coefficients, and functional determinants (all rational, or reducible to $\zeta_R(\mathrm{odd})$ and $\log 2$); and (vii) a ζ-combination scan for Δ over 3,228 candidates built from Riemann and Hurwitz zetas, Bernoulli numbers, and Stieltjes constants, with zero strict hits within 10^{-25} of $1/40$.

The structural reason for these negative results is that round-sphere Laplace–Beltrami operators produce (i) integer powers of π in their volumes, (ii) rational Seeley–DeWitt coefficients, and (iii) $\zeta_R(\mathrm{odd}) + \log 2$ combinations in their spectral determinants—but never $\pi^2 = 2\zeta_R(2)$ additively next to a rational. This is consistent with the π-free certificate of the Bargmann–Segal lattice (Paper 24), which shows that the analogous lattice for the 3D harmonic oscillator on the Hardy space of S^5 is bit-exactly rational in exact arithmetic; and the same rigidity holds for S^5 Laplace–Beltrami spectral invariants generally.

e. Reframed open question. The derivation question "where does each piece of K come from?" has been partially answered: B from a finite Casimir truncation (with the κ–B link of Eq. 31), F from an infinite Dirichlet series at the packing exponent (Eq. 33), and Δ from a boundary product at the truncation edge (irreducible to ζ-content within the candidate set tested). The remaining structural question is no longer a derivation question about any single component: it is a question about why the *additive* combination $B + F - \Delta$, multiplied by the overall factor $\omega_2 = \pi$, approximately equals α^{-1} (to 4.8×10^{-7}; to 8.8×10^{-8} through the cubic's root). That is a question about the conspiracy of three categorically different objects—a finite sum, an infinite Dirichlet series, and a boundary product—rather than the specialization of a single generator. Paper 2's identification remains an Observation.

VI. OBSERVABLE CLASSIFICATION BY TRANSCENDENTAL CONTENT

The exchange constant taxonomy (Sec. IV) classifies the *constants themselves* by their mathematical origin. A complementary classification addresses the *observables*: given a physical quantity to be computed, what class of transcendental content does it require?

The conformal equivalence between the label-set and

continuous descriptions (Paper 7) implies a natural partition of observables into three classes, determined by what type of projection is needed to evaluate them.

1. **Class S (spectral observables):** Energy eigenvalues, degeneracies, selection rules, and transition amplitudes between eigenstates. These require only the label set, its Casimir eigenvalues n^2-1 and the energy shell $p_0^2 = -2E$ (all rational), not the graph Laplacian's spectrum. No transcendental content is needed.

2. **Class P (single-particle spatial observables):** Electron density $\rho(\mathbf{r})$, expectation values $\langle r^k \rangle$, momentum distributions, and any quantity requiring the wavefunction evaluated at a point in $\mathbb{R}^3$. These require the conformal projection $S^3 \to \mathbb{R}^3$, which introduces π through the volume element $d\Omega_{S^3} = 2\pi^2$ and the spherical harmonic normalization $\int |Y_{lm}|^2 d\Omega = 1$ (with $d\Omega$ carrying 4π).

3. **Class C (multi-particle correlated observables):** Correlation energies, adiabatic potential energy surfaces, multi-electron expectation values, and any quantity requiring the inter-particle coordinate. The higher exchange constants appear here: $e^a E_1(a)$ at Level 2 for $m \neq 0$ states (Sec. II B), $\mu(R)$ at Level 3 (Sec. II C), $\mu(\rho, R)$ at Level 4 (Sec. II D), and the PK composition constant at Level 5.

This classification is stated as a structural claim:

Claim 4. *The class of transcendental content required to evaluate a quantum-mechanical observable is determined by the type of projection linking the discrete label-set description to the coordinate system in which the observable is defined. Spectral observables (Class S) require no transcendental content. Single-particle spatial observables (Class P) require the Weyl constants ($\pi^{d/2}$). Multi-particle correlated observables (Class C) are where the embedding, algebraic-implicit, or composition exchange constants of Sec. IV appear.*

[SCOPE 2026-09-14] An earlier wording said Class-C observables *require* those constants, and the abstract still states the claim in the stronger, observable-indexed form ("the transcendental content of any GeoVac observable is determined entirely by the type of projection"). Sec. II D puts that under strain: the H_2 dissociation energy is a multi-particle correlated observable, and a prolate product space reaches ∼99% of it by a route whose exchange constant this paper has not yet priced. Whether that is a counterexample to the strong form or a route that carries an unpriced constant is the open question recorded there. Pending it, the body states the weaker claim—the classification tracks which constants *appear* in a given evaluation route—and the two forms are not reconciled. **This is a live tension in the paper's headline claim, not a settled scoping.**

Claim 4 is falsifiable: for any observable, one can determine its class, identify the required exchange constants, and verify that no additional transcendental content enters the computation. The following worked examples illustrate each class.

A. Example 1: Hydrogen energy levels (Class S)

The hydrogen energy spectrum $E_n = -Z^2/(2n^2)$ is a spectral observable. The continuum S^3 Laplace–Beltrami operator (whose harmonics the graph's nodes label, and whose negative acts on those labels as the diagonal $SO(4)$ Casimir; the graph's edge Laplacian does not converge to it) has eigenvalues $\lambda_n = -(n^2-1)$, which are integers for all n (Paper 7, Eq. (12); Paper 0, Sec. II). The degeneracies $g_n = n^2$ are integers. The Fock conformal mapping (Paper 7, Sec. IV) converts these integer eigenvalues to the Rydberg spectrum via the energy-shell constraint $p_0^2 = -2E$ and the stereographic focal length:

$$E_n = -\frac{Z^2}{2n^2}\ \text{Ha}, \tag{34}$$

with the calibration constant $\kappa = -1/16$ (rational) matching the graph's extremal eigenvalue, a band edge, to the ground state $-\frac{1}{2}$ (an Observation, Sec. VII F); the Rydberg ladder itself comes from the labels and the energy shell, not from the graph spectrum. Every quantity in this derivation—eigenvalues, degeneracies, κ—is an integer or rational number. No transcendental content enters.

Selection rules provide a second example. The dipole selection rule $\Delta l = \pm 1$ follows from the triangle inequality on the Gaunt integral $\int Y_{l_1 m_1} Y_{1q} Y_{l_2 m_2}\, d\Omega$, which reduces to a product of Wigner $3j$ symbols—rational numbers computed from factorials of integers [1]. No transcendental content enters.

B. Example 2: Electron density (Class P)

The electron density $\rho(\mathbf{r}) = |\psi(\mathbf{r})|^2$ requires evaluating the wavefunction in position space. On the graph, the state $|n, l, m\rangle$ is a node with an integer label; in $\mathbb{R}^3$, the corresponding wavefunction is $\psi_{nlm}(\mathbf{r}) = R_{nl}(r)\, Y_{lm}(\theta, \phi)$. The conformal projection $S^3 \to \mathbb{R}^3$ (Paper 7, Sec. III) introduces the conformal factor $\Omega = 2p_0/(p^2 + p_0^2)$, which mediates between the unit-sphere measure $d\Omega_{S^3}$ and the flat-space volume element $d^3\mathbf{r}$. The spherical harmonic normalization $\int |Y_{lm}|^2\, d\Omega = 1$ introduces π through the solid angle $\oint d\Omega = 4\pi$. The radial normalization $\int_0^\infty |R_{nl}|^2\, r^2\, dr = 1$ introduces no additional transcendentals for hydrogen (the integrals are rational multiples of a_0^{-3} times exponentials, evaluated in closed form).

The density is thus a Class P observable: it requires the π that enters through the projection from the dimensionless S^3 topology to the dimensionful $\mathbb{R}^3$ coordinate system.

C. Example 3: Helium ground state energy (Class C)

The helium ground state energy $E_0 = -2.9037$ Ha [26] is a correlated observable. The Level 3 hyperspherical solver (Paper 13) computes it via the adiabatic potential $U(R)$, which depends on the angular eigenvalue $\mu(R)$. The function $\mu(R)$ satisfies the characteristic polynomial $P(R, \mu) = 0$ (Sec. VII E), with coefficients in $\mathbb{Q}(\pi, \sqrt{2})$ inherited from the angular coupling matrix [24]. The energy is obtained by integrating the hyperradial Schrödinger equation with $U(R)$ as the effective potential—a definite integral over the algebraic curve, producing a transcendental number.

On the $S^3 \times S^3$ product space (Level 3 FCI), the same energy can in principle be computed without $\mu(R)$: the Hamiltonian matrix has entries given by Gaunt integrals (rational) and the Slater F^0 direct Coulomb integrals (exact rationals, classical; Parseval form in Paper 7 Sec. V). The FCI result (1.88% at $n_{\max} = 7$ with the physical Hamiltonian; an earlier sub-percent figure belonged to a withdrawn hop-augmented model) demonstrates that the correlated energy *can* be approximated within the algebraic framework, but the $\mu(R)$ parameterization was once thought necessary for sub-0.1% accuracy.

[WITHDRAWN 2026-09-14] It is not, and the claim fails in both directions: the adiabatic route that *carries* $\mu(R)$ floors at 0.19–0.20% and never reaches sub-0.1%, while sub-0.1% is reached *without* it by the 2D variational solver, which treats R and α simultaneously (0.022% raw at $l_{\max} = 7$). The Class-S to Class-C reading in the next sentence does not depend on the withdrawn necessity claim and is left standing. The transition from Class S to Class C reflects the physical content: electron-electron correlation couples the two S^3 factors, and the coupling strength varies with the hyperradial coordinate R—a spatial degree of freedom that exists only in the projected description.

a. Three-layer decomposition (v2.6.0). The algebraic Casimir CI (Track DI Sprint 2) makes the exchange constant structure of the He ground state fully explicit. At each $n_{\max}$, the FCI matrix $H(k) = Bk + Ck^2$ has rational entries as a function of the orbital exponent k, so the variationally optimal energy E^* is an algebraic number—a root of a polynomial with rational coefficients. At $n_{\max} = 1$: $k^* = 27/16$, $E^* = -729/256$ Ha (exact rationals). This reveals a three-layer structure:

Layer	Content	Exchange type
Rational	Slater integrals, Gaunt coefficients	None (label-intrinsic)
Algebraic	Optimal exponents at finite $n_{\max}$	Calibration
Transcendental	e-e cusp ($\alpha = \pi/4$ on S^5)	Embedding

The Fock energy-shell self-consistency $k^2 = -2E$, which is exact at Level 1 (one electron, one scale), overconstrains the two-electron problem: self-consistent k gives 5–13% error vs. 1.5–1.9% for variational k. This is the first instance where a single calibration constant is insufficient—the transition from calibration to embedding exchange constants corresponds to the physical content of electron-electron correlation.

D. Boundary cases

Two boundary cases clarify the classification:

- **Ionization energies** are spectral (Class S) when computed as eigenvalue differences $\Delta E = E_n - E_m$, which involve only integer quantum numbers and the rational energy-shell map (not κ, which matches only the graph's band edge). However, photoionization *cross sections* require the dipole matrix element $\langle \psi_f | \mathbf{r} | \psi_i \rangle$, which is a spatial observable (Class P) because it evaluates the wavefunction at positions in $\mathbb{R}^3$.

- **Two-electron energies** computed via FCI on $S^3 \times S^3$ are formally Class S (eigenvalues of the rational product-space Hamiltonian matrix). **[SCOPE 2026-09-14]** Earlier versions added that they "achieve limited accuracy due to the product-basis completeness deficiency" and that "high-accuracy two-electron energies require the Class C exchange constants." The completeness deficiency was a σ-sector restriction (Sec. II D), so the *require* does not follow: a product-space basis with the azimuthal axis open reaches ∼99% of D_e without any Class C constant. What the classification tracks is the type of observable; whether it also tracks an accuracy target is no longer established.

The classification does not assert that one class is more fundamental than another. The conformal equivalence (Paper 7) ensures that all three descriptions—discrete label set, projected single-particle, correlated multi-particle—are mathematically equivalent. The classification identifies which exchange constants mediate between them.

VII. DISCUSSION

A. Transcendence and the label-set design principle

Exchange constants are transcendental because they convert between incommensurable descriptions: a discrete count (eigenvalues, representation labels) and a continuous measure (volume, curvature, geodesic length). Weyl constants carry $\pi^{d/2}$, and π is transcendental by Lindemann's theorem. Not all functions in the hierarchy are transcendental: $\mu(R)$ satisfies a polynomial $P(R, \mu) = 0$ (Sec. VII E), making it algebraic in R, with transcendental content inherited from angular coupling coefficients [30]. The irreducible transcendentals are the

constants that enter the coupling matrix, not the parameterized functions built from them.

When the computation stays on the discrete label set (its rational and algebraic matrix elements), exchange constants are unnecessary. This suggests a design principle: *minimize coordinate projections* to minimize transcendental content. The ideal solver stays on the label set; every departure incurs a transcendental toll.

B. Exchange constants are computationally cheap

Conceptual complexity does not correlate with computational cost: the Level-1 energy-shell map is one multiplication; $e^a E_1(a)$ is one function evaluation seeding an $O(N^2)$ recurrence; $\mu(R)$ is a 10–30 dimensional matrix diagonalization per R-point. The hierarchy tracks curvature mismatch severity, not computational difficulty. At Level 2, identifying the Stieltjes seed and absorbing it into the basis *reduces* cost (eliminating quadrature) while improving convergence (Sec. II B).

C. The hierarchy of transcendence

Exchange constants increase in complexity with curvature mismatch: constant (the energy-shell scale p_0, Level 1; the matched $\kappa = -1/16$ is rational) $\rightarrow$ single transcendental seed ($e^a E_1(a)$, Level 2) $\rightarrow$ algebraic function of one parameter ($\mu(R)$ satisfying $P(R,\mu) = 0$ over $\mathbb{Q}(\pi, \sqrt{2})$, Level 3) $\rightarrow$ piecewise-algebraic function of two parameters ($\mu(\rho, R)$, Level 4). This mirrors the mathematical hierarchy: Weyl constants are periods ($\pi = \int dx/(1+x^2)$), Stieltjes seeds are exponential periods ($E_1(a) = \int_1^\infty e^{-at}/t\, dt$), and adiabatic eigenvalues are algebraic functions of the continuous parameter built from transcendental coefficients.

D. Structural parallels

The pattern parallels string compactification, where compact internal geometry determines low-energy couplings [37]. We note also that $\mathrm{SO}(4,2) = \mathrm{Iso}(\mathrm{AdS}_5)$, the isometry group of five-dimensional anti-de Sitter space, is the conformal group of the boundary $\mathbb{R}^{3,1}$; the Fock projection $S^3 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ is a Euclidean section of this conformal boundary correspondence.

E. The algebraic curve refinement

The characteristic polynomial analysis [24] refines the exchange constant taxonomy by distinguishing between transcendental *constants* and algebraic *functions* of continuous parameters:

- **Truly irreducible transcendentals:** The embedding constants $e^a E_1(a)$ (Level 2, $m \neq 0$) and the angular coupling integrals c/π and $c\sqrt{2}/\pi$ (Level 3 and 4) are irreducible—they cannot be eliminated by any algebraic manipulation. These are the genuine "exchange constants" in the Weyl–Selberg sense.

- **Algebraic functions of transcendental data:** The Level-3 adiabatic eigenvalues $\mu(R)$ are algebraic functions whose coefficients inherit transcendentals from the coupling matrix. The R-dependence is algebraic at every truncation: μ satisfies a polynomial equation $P(R,\mu) = 0$ of degree d equal to the matrix dimension. At $l_{\max} = 0$, P is linear and $\mu(R)$ is an explicit rational function of R (with transcendental coefficients). At $l_{\max} = L$, P has degree $L+1$ in both R and μ.

  [SCOPE 2026-09-14] An earlier version of this bullet extended the same statement to the Level-4 angular eigenvalues $\mu(\rho, R)$. It does not carry over as written: the construction above is a linear matrix pencil $H_0 + R \cdot V_C$, which is what supplies the single global $P(R,\mu) = 0$, and the Level-4 sweep is not of that form: the Level-4 eigenvalues are piecewise-algebraic with no global characteristic polynomial (Sec. II D).

- **Matched scale:** $\kappa = -1/16$ is rational (Sec. VII F); it is matched to the graph band edge, not a calibration constant — the calibration content of Level 1 sits in the p_0 energy shell.

This refinement has a practical implication: the "transcendental toll" of the adiabatic parameterization is *inherited*, not *accrued*. Moving from the product space $S^3 \times S^3$ to hyperspherical coordinates does not introduce new transcendental content; it rearranges existing transcendentals (from the angular coupling) into an algebraic function of R. The toll is paid once, in the coupling matrix, and the R-dependence is algebraically determined.

This does not yet eliminate the computational cost of pointwise diagonalization: at $l_{\max} \geq 1$, the characteristic polynomial has degree ≥ 2 in μ and must be solved numerically at each R-point. But it does mean that the solver operates on a known polynomial, not an opaque transcendental function. Whether this algebraic structure can be exploited computationally—for instance, via resultant methods, homotopy continuation, or algebraic PES representations—is an open question.

This algebraic structure is specific to Level 3, where the angular Hamiltonian $H(R) = H_0 + R \cdot V_C$ is a linear matrix pencil. At Level 4, the split-region Legendre expansion of the nuclear charge function introduces piecewise-smooth ρ-dependence that breaks the pencil structure (Track S). The Level 4 angular eigenvalues are piecewise-algebraic but do not satisfy a global characteristic polynomial.

F. Two routes to the value of $\kappa = -1/16$

The original identification of $\kappa = -1/16$ (Paper 0) was empirical: the constant that matches the GeoVac graph's extremal eigenvalue (a band edge, $\lambda_{\max} \to 8$) to the hydrogen ground state $-\frac{1}{2}$. (It was once read as mapping the graph spectrum onto the Rydberg levels; it does not, since the rest of the graph spectrum is a grid band structure, Paper 7.) Below we give two independent routes to its numerical value and classify their agreement. As recorded in Paper 0 and Paper 7, that the calibration scale coincides with a conformal-geometry quantity is an *Observation*—a numerical coincidence with no known derivation bridging the two—not a derivation of κ's calibration role from the geometry.

Graph Laplacian spectrum. The GeoVac lattice (Paper 0) has the S^3 label set as nodes, states $|n, l, m\rangle$ (it is not a discretization of Δ_{S^3}: its edges preserve l, Paper 0 §VI), connected by angular transitions $m \leftrightarrow m \pm 1$ and radial transitions $n \leftrightarrow n \pm 1$. Interior nodes have degree $d_{\max} = 4$ (two angular, two radial neighbors). The graph Laplacian $\mathcal{L} = D - A$ is positive semidefinite; its maximum eigenvalue satisfies $\lambda_{\max} \leq 2d_{\max} = 8$, with the bound saturated as $n_{\max} \to \infty$ (the band edge of two-dimensional grids, not an S^3 limit). Numerically: $\lambda_{\max}(n_{\max}{=}5) = 6.62$, $\lambda_{\max}(10) = 7.61$, $\lambda_{\max}(20) = 7.90 \to 8$.

Energy calibration. The graph Hamiltonian $H = \kappa\mathcal{L}$ (no node weights) has its ground state at energy $\kappa\lambda_{\max}$, since $\kappa < 0$ maps the largest graph eigenvalue to the lowest physical energy. Matching this to the hydrogen ground state:

$$\kappa\lambda_{\max} = E_H = -\tfrac{1}{2} \implies \kappa = \frac{-1/2}{8} = -\frac{1}{16}. \qquad (35)$$

Factor identification. The value $-1/16 = -(1/2)(1/8)$ decomposes into:

1. $1/2$: the non-relativistic kinetic energy normalization $E = p^2/(2m)$, or equivalently the energy-shell constraint $E = -p_0^2/2$;
2. $1/8 = 1/(2d_{\max})$: the inverse of the maximum graph Laplacian eigenvalue, determined by the vertex degree of the lattice (a grid band edge).

Heat kernel test. The Seeley–DeWitt coefficients on unit S^3 (scalar Laplacian, $(4\pi)^{3/2}$-normalised: $a_0 = 2\pi^2$, $a_1 = 2\pi^2$, $a_2 = \pi^2$) produce no ratio matching $1/16$; neither does the Weyl counting function $N(\Lambda) \sim \Lambda^{3/2}/3$ or the spectral zeta. The conformal coupling $c_3 = 1/8$ for $d = 3$ numerically equals $1/\lambda_{\max}$, but this is coincidental: c_3 is a Yamabe invariant while $1/\lambda_{\max}$ depends on graph vertex degree.

Fock weight coincidence (Note added v2.26.1). **[OBSERVATION]** The same value $1/16$ also appears in the Fock projection itself, without reference to graph vertex degree; that it coincides with the matched κ is an Observation, not an independent derivation of κ. The $l = 0$ eigenfunctions on S^3 are Gegenbauer polynomials $C^1_{n-1}(\cos\chi)$ (equivalently, Chebyshev polynomials of the second kind $U_{n-1}(\cos\chi)$). Their three-term recurrence gives transition amplitudes of $1/2$ between adjacent shells, so the squared inter-shell coupling is

$$c^2(n, l) = \tfrac{1}{4}\big[1 - l(l{+}1)/(n(n{+}1))\big], \qquad (36)$$

with $c^2(n, 0) = 1/4$ for all n (Paper 7, corrected 2026-09-03 from a printed $1/16$ prefactor). The quantity that coincides with $1/16$ is the fourth power of the inverse conformal factor, $1/\Omega^4(0)$, where $\Omega(0) = 2$ is the stereographic conformal factor at $p = 0$ (equivalently $c^2(n, 0)/4$). The graph-degree matching (Eq. 35) and the Fock weight route yield the same value, but from unrelated inputs: the graph's maximum vertex degree $d_{\max} = 4$ is fixed by the lattice's two-dimensional grid structure (each l-block is a grid, Paper 0 §VI), not by S^3 geometry, while the conformal factor $\Omega(0) = 2$ is fixed by the Fock projection ($2d_{\max} = 8$, while $\Omega(0)^4 = 16$ — two different integers; an earlier version printed a false identity between them, corrected 2026-09-03; an earlier version also said both were fixed by "the unit-S^3 geometry the graph discretizes", corrected 2026-09-25). That the calibration scale κ equals this geometric value is the Observation; no derivation links the two.

A notable special case: at $(n, l) = (4, 3)$ the Casimir factor $2/5$ times $1/\Omega^4(0)$ gives $1/40 = \Delta$ (Paper 2), an Observation about a composite of two geometric quantities (the coupling itself is $c^2(4, 3) = 1/10$), linking the Paper 2 cutoff to the Dirac degeneracy $g_3^{\text{Dirac}} = 40$.

Classification. In Table I κ is listed beside the "conformal" tier's energy shell only as a matched scale: its numerical value $1/16$ *coincides* with the conformal-geometry quantity $1/\Omega^4(0)$ of the Fock projection, but it is the energy shell, not κ, that carries the spectrum into atomic units. The two routes (graph degree and conformal factor) return the same number from unrelated inputs—the graph degree is a grid property, not an S^3 one; that the calibration scale κ equals it is an *Observation* (a numerical coincidence, no known derivation bridge), consistent with the Observation-tier status of κ recorded in Paper 0 and Paper 7. The Z-universality noted in Paper 0 ($\kappa \to \kappa Z^2$ for any nuclear charge) is a property of the energy shell ($p_0 = Z/n$, $E \propto Z^2$), not evidence about the graph's spectrum, which does not carry the Rydberg ladder at any Z (Paper 7).

VIII. STRUCTURAL INCOMMENSURABILITY WITHIN GEOVAC OBSERVABLES

The exchange-constant taxonomy developed in the preceding sections has repeatedly encountered a distinctive pattern: single framework observables in GeoVac, when unpacked, resolve into sums or products of categorically distinct transcendental or spectral objects with *no common generator*. The pattern has been observed in three independently-derived three-axis classifications.

We name it for future reference: *structural incommensurability within GeoVac observables.*

Observation 5 (Structural incommensurability)**.** *Across the framework, single-observable statements ("two-loop QED spectral sum on S^3", "$K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$", "zero structure of the GeoVac zeta") have repeatedly resolved under structural analysis into sums or superpositions of objects of categorically different type (finite traces, infinite Dirichlet series, boundary degeneracies; for K, B and F share a cell of the classification of Theorem 2). The objects at each cell are what they are, not derivations of each other; the appropriate taxonomy is three-axis, not single-generator. The status is empirical at three documented instances; it may sharpen if further framework observables decompose the same way or if a bridge is found that fails cleanly.*

a. Instance 1 (QED on S^3, Paper 28). Perturbative QED sums on S^3 [13] produce three transcendental classes simultaneously: even-zeta content (π^{even}, from second-order Riemannian operators), odd-zeta content ($\zeta(3), \zeta(5)$, from first-order Dirac), and Dirichlet-L content ($G = \beta(2), \beta(4)$, from vertex topology). These three classes appear together in the two-loop sunset sum but are discriminated by Theorem 2's three axes (operator order × bundle type × vertex parity), and no single mechanism generates all three.

b. Instance 2 (α-combination decomposition). By Theorem 5, the observed combination rule $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$ has three components with structurally distinct spectral homes: $B = 42$ is a finite Casimir trace on the scalar Laplacian at $n_{\max} = 3$; $F = \pi^2/6$ is the infinite Dirichlet series of Fock degeneracies at the packing exponent $d_{\max} = 4$; and $\Delta^{-1} = 40$ is the degeneracy $g_3^{\text{Dirac}} = 2 \cdot 4 \cdot 5$ of the third Dirac mode on the spinor bundle. No common generator producing all three has been exhibited (twelve candidates eliminated; an empirical record, Paper 2); K assembles three structurally-independent spectral objects. In the gauge-structure language of Paper 25 [11] and the SU(2) Wilson extension of Paper 30 [15], K/π has the shape of a finite-cutoff spectral-action coefficient (matter trace + gauge zeta + Dirac boundary mode count).

c. Instance 3 (Weil dictionary on the GeoVac Hopf graphs, Paper 29). The Ihara-zeta side (combinatorial, closed non-backtracking walks) and the spectral-Dirichlet side (Dirac-eigenvalue Dirichlet series) of the same Hopf graph [14] give *opposite* verdicts. Zero spacing: Ihara Poisson (CV ≈ 1), spectral GUE (CV ≈ 0.35). Dirichlet-L content: Ihara absent (bipartiteness makes the χ_{-4} support disjoint from walk-length support); spectral present in the closed form of Eq. (7). Hilbert–Pólya compatibility: Ihara categorically excluded; spectral compatible at current sample precision. The two sides are not two views of the same object; they are two distinct framework observables computed from the same Dirac-S^3 data, with structural support that is disjoint in the bipartite-χ_{-4} sense.

d. Origin: Paper 24's Coulomb/HO asymmetry. The meta-pattern is consistent with—and arguably a consequence of—the Coulomb/HO asymmetry established in Paper 24 [10]: the graph's matrix entries are rational/integer on both bundles (its eigenvalues algebraic), but the projection structures (second-order Riemannian for the scalar, first-order complex-analytic for the HO holomorphic sector, Dirac for the spinor) are categorically different. Paper 25 [11] sharpens this further: abelian U(1) Wilson–Hodge structure transfers verbatim from S^3 to the Bargmann–Segal S^5 graph, and pure-gauge SU(3) on the $(N, 0)$ irreps is well defined, but its natural coupling to matter fails (Clebsch–Gordan intertwiners are not group elements), making gauge with natural matter coupling Coulomb-specific (Paper 24 §V). The universal/Coulomb partition therefore has one layer here: Wilson gauge with natural matter coupling (full S^3, reduced S^5). Neither calibration π nor a spectrum-computing role of the graph Laplacian L_0 separates the two spheres: π enters both through a measure and through spectral sums (Paper 24 §V), and the S^3 edge Laplacian does not compute the hydrogen spectrum, since it does not converge to Δ_{S^3} (Paper 0 §VI).

e. Operational consequence. For taxonomy construction (Sec. IV), the consequence is that multi-component observables should be decomposed and each component classified separately, rather than the whole observable forced into a single tier. This changes nothing about Sec. VI's S/P/C classification of atomic observables (which are fine as they stand at the observable level), but it does mean that composite structural results—such as Paper 2's K or Paper 28's two-loop sunset—should be broken into their components before taxonomic assignment.

IX. CONCLUSION

The exchange-constant taxonomy of Sec. IV now admits three theorems and one observation, alongside the catalogued constants of Levels 1–5:

a. Theorem 1 (operator-order discriminant). On round S^3, the squared Dirac operator D^2 has spectral zeta $\zeta_{D^2}(s) = 2^{2s-1}[\lambda(2s-2) - \lambda(2s)]$ which is a polynomial in π^2 at every integer $s \geq 2$ (Eq. 21); the first-order Dirac operator has spectral zeta containing odd-zeta content $\zeta_R(2k+1)$ at odd s, conjecturally outside $\mathbb{Q}(\pi)$ (Eq. 22). Between D and D^2, operator order is the primary transcendental discriminant (conditional on the period conjecture; $\nabla^*\nabla$, also second order, does not follow it, Paper 28); bundle type modulates rational coefficients only. Loop-order reading (consistent with the known coefficients, not a prediction made in advance): no odd zeta in the one-loop flat-space a_e (Schwinger [40], $a_e^{(1)} = \alpha/2\pi$) or in the integer-s values of ζ_{D^2} (the one-loop determinant $\zeta'_{D^2}(0)$ does carry $\zeta(3)$); $\zeta_R(3)$ at two loops (Petermann [41]; Sommerfield [42]).

b. Theorem 2 (three-axis classification). The transcendental content of the integer-s spectral-zeta values on round S^3 is determined by three independent axes (determinants and half-integer s are outside the statement; the operator-order separation is conditional on the period conjecture): (A1) operator order (1st vs. 2nd) via Theorem 1; (A2) bundle type (scalar vs. spinor) modulating coefficients; (A3) diagram topology (free vs. vertex-restricted) introducing Dirichlet L-values ($G = \beta(2)$, $\beta(4)$) through the quarter-integer Hurwitz shift. The taxonomy is R-independent: $D(s,R)/R^s$ is a structural invariant, and Weyl's law preserves the even/odd-s discriminant in the flat-space limit.

c. Theorem 3 (three spectral homes of distinct type for B, F, Δ). The three components of Paper 2's $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$ have spectral origins of distinct type: B a finite Casimir trace on the scalar Laplacian at $n_{\max} = 3$; $F = D_{n^2}(d_{\max}) = \zeta_R(2)$ an infinite Dirichlet series of Fock degeneracies at the packing exponent; $\Delta^{-1} = g_3^{\text{Dirac}} = 40$ a finite Dirac mode degeneracy on the spinor bundle. No common generator producing all three has been exhibited (an empirical record, Paper 2). The combination rule $K \approx \alpha^{-1}$ (to 4.8×10^{-7}; Observation 4) remains a numerical Observation without first-principles derivation.

d. Observation (structural incommensurability). The three theorems share a meta-pattern: framework observables that look unitary at the surface ("$K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$"; "two-loop QED on S^3"; "zero structure of the GeoVac zeta") resolve under structural analysis into objects of different type (not always different cells of the operator-order × bundle × topology grid: K's B and F share one). Observation 5 catalogues three independent instances; no further unification is currently visible.

e. Verified and open. The taxonomy has been validated across the full GeoVac hierarchy through Level 5; Claim 4 (transcendental content determined by projection type) has held across all tested cases *in its route-relative form.* Its stronger, observable-indexed form—the one this paper's abstract states—is under strain from the Level-4 azimuthal result of Sec. II D, and the two forms are not currently reconciled; see the open question recorded in Sec. VI. What remains open: (i) whether the three-axis classification of Theorem 2 predicts the physical two-loop coefficient (not just the transcendental class); (ii) the combination rule $K = \pi(B + F - \Delta)$ of Observation 4, whose component decomposition is now Theorem 5 but whose additive conspiracy remains unexplained; (iii) whether the structural incommensurability of Observation 5 sharpens to a theorem when further composite observables are decomposed.

f. Design principle. Staying on the discrete label set eliminates exchange constants by eliminating projections. The program's effort to algebraicize solvers (Paper 12's Neumann expansion, Laguerre recurrences, Gaunt replacements, Paper 19's cross-center V_{ne} via incomplete gamma functions) is, in retrospect, an effort to eliminate exchange constants. The algebraic curve result (Sec. VII E) shows this has been more successful than previously recognized.

g. Note added v2.6.0. The He exchange constant census (Track DI) was read as validating the taxonomy computationally. **[WITHDRAWN 2026-09-25]** Its headline—a "graph-native" FCI at 0.216% from exact at [retracted 2026-09-25: he-graph-native-hop-headline] $n_{\max} = 7$—and the three-layer split built on it (rational h_1 + Slater V_{ee}; a "topological" layer of graph off-diagonal $T_\pm$ entries scaled by κ, read as dominant; a transcendental cusp floor) are withdrawn. The off-diagonal entries were a $+\frac{1}{16}$ per-edge hop that is not part of helium's Hamiltonian (in the $k = Z$ basis $T + V_{ne}$ is exactly diagonal); it lowers the energy by ≈ 49 mHa, more than the correlation energy, so the withdrawn 0.216% is a hop-augmented model, not a helium result. With the physical Hamiltonian in the same basis the error at $n_{\max} = 7$ is 1.88% (above the Hartree–Fock limit): the floor is continuum incompleteness of the fixed-k basis, neither the cusp (withdrawn 2026-09-14) nor a small-Z graph-validity boundary [retracted 2026-09-25: he-graph-native-hop-headline] (withdrawn 2026-09-25). FCI basis invariance holds for either one-body operator and bears on neither reading. See Paper 13, Sec. "Conclusion."

h. Note added v2.26.1 (Seeley–DeWitt comparison; corrected 2026-10-02). An earlier version of this note stated that on unit S^3 the Seeley–DeWitt ratio of D^2 to Δ_{LB} is $\dim(S)$ at every order, so that the perturbative Connes–Chamseddine supertrace vanishes identically in the asymptotic expansion. That is withdrawn: the exact heat traces are $\operatorname{Tr} e^{-tD^2} = (\sqrt{\pi}/2)\, t^{-3/2} - (\sqrt{\pi}/4)\, t^{-1/2}$ (Camporesi–Higuchi spectrum $\pm(n+\frac{3}{2})$ with multiplicity $(n+1)(n+2)$ each, up to exponentially small terms) and $\operatorname{Tr} e^{-t\Delta_{\text{LB}}} = e^{t}(\sqrt{\pi}/4)\, t^{-3/2}$ (every coefficient non-zero), so the coefficient ratio is 2 at order 0, -1 at order 1 and 0 beyond. The mode densities fix only the leading coefficient. What survives is that the three ingredients of $K/\pi = B+F-\Delta$ are not Seeley–DeWitt coefficients (the T9 obstruction, Paper 2): B is a finite Casimir trace, F is an arithmetic Dirichlet series, and $\Delta^{-1} = 40$ is the Dirac mode degeneracy g_3^{Dirac} at $n_{\text{CH}} = 3$ (the Euler–Maclaurin upper boundary term of the mode-count sum is half of it, 20; Paper 2). The sign on Δ in the combination rule $K = \pi(B+F-\Delta)$ is consistent with the $(-1)^F$ grading (a reading, not a derivation): B and F are scalar-sector (bosonic) quantities that enter with $(+)$, while Δ is a spinor-sector (fermionic) quantity that enters with $(-)$. (The former conclusion that K/π lives entirely in the non-perturbative sector of the supertrace rested on the withdrawn vanishing and is withdrawn with it.)

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

Computational implementation and documentation drafting were performed with the assistance of large lan-

guage models (Anthropic Claude) under the author's scientific direction. All results were validated against analytical benchmarks.

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